

Lecture 8

Dr Qiao Cheng
qiao.cheng@lancaster.ac.uk

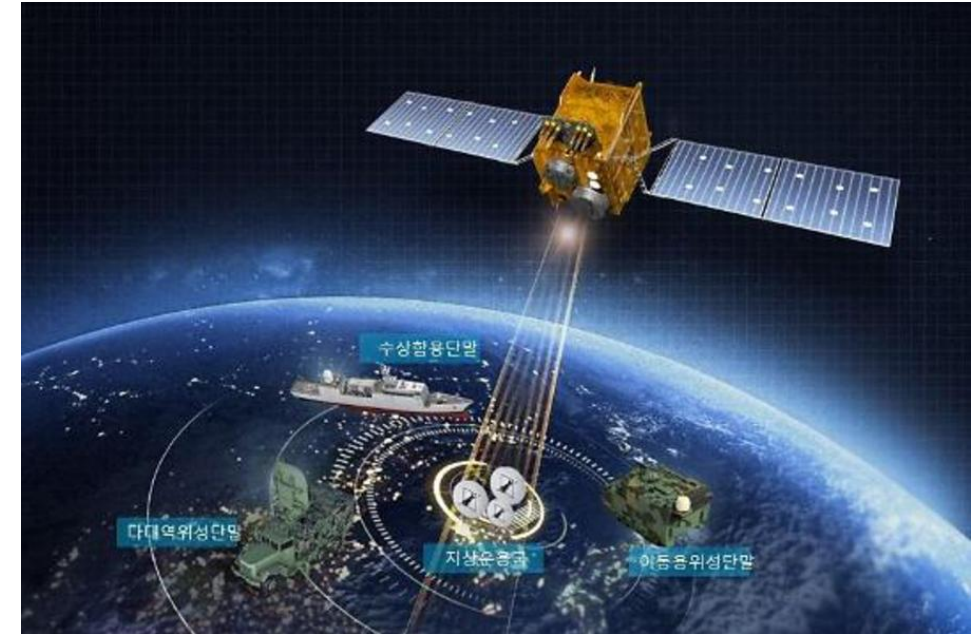
SCC.160:
Fundamentals of Communication Systems

Satellite Communications



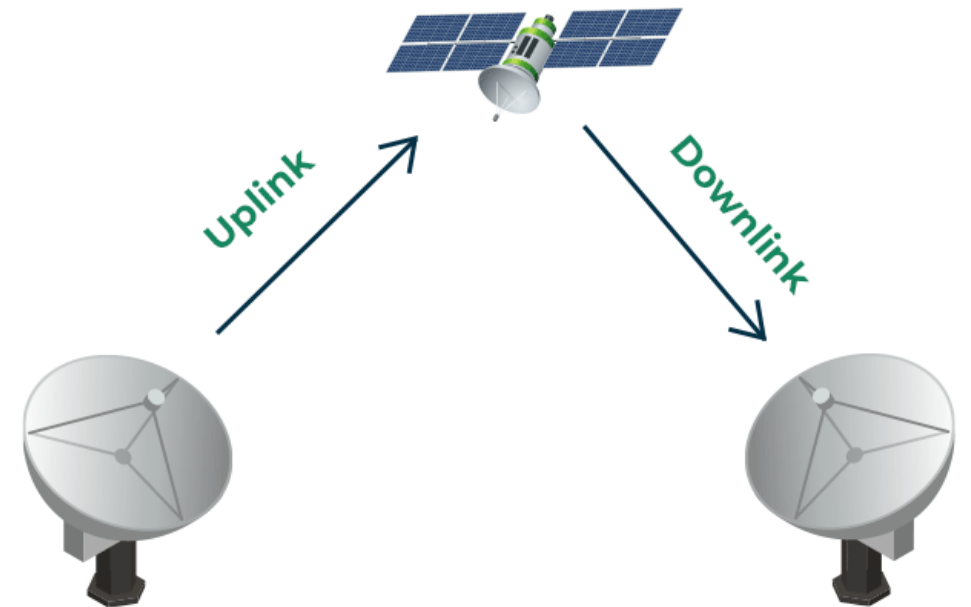
What is Satellite Communication?

- Satellite communications involve the **use of artificial satellites** to send and receive signals for **media and data communications** across large distances.
- This technology is essential in **bridging geographical gaps** where traditional means of communication are **unfeasible or economically impractical**.



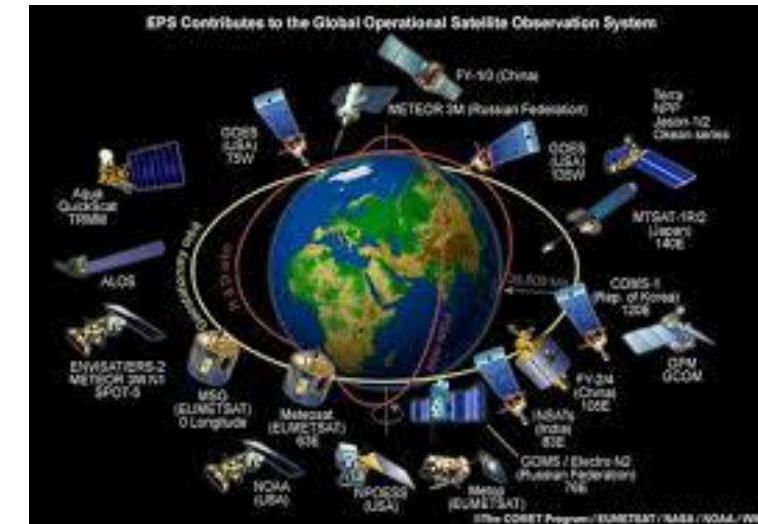
Functionality

- Satellites act as **repeaters** or **transponders** in space, receiving signals transmitted from a **ground station**, amplifying these signals, and retransmitting them back to another location on earth.
- This process allows for **communication between two distant points on Earth** that might not have direct line-of-sight communication due to Earth's curvature.



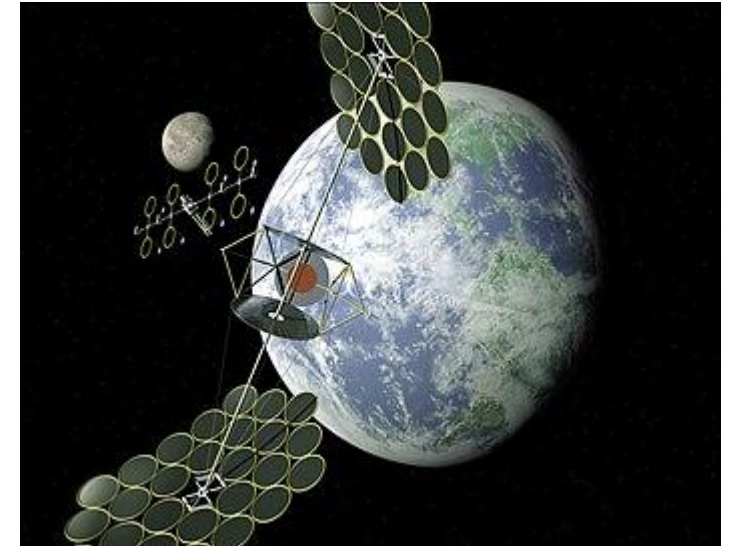
Importance and Uses of Satellite Communications

- **Broadband internet provision to remote areas**
 - Satellites provide internet access to regions where terrestrial internet infrastructure is lacking or non-existent, such as rural or isolated geographic areas
- **Critical for global media broadcasts**
 - Satellites enable the global distribution of television and radio programming, allowing live events to be broadcast worldwide simultaneously
- **Essential for navigation systems like GPS**
 - The Global Positioning System , which relies on a constellation of satellites, provides critical positioning services for military, commercial, and personal use around the world



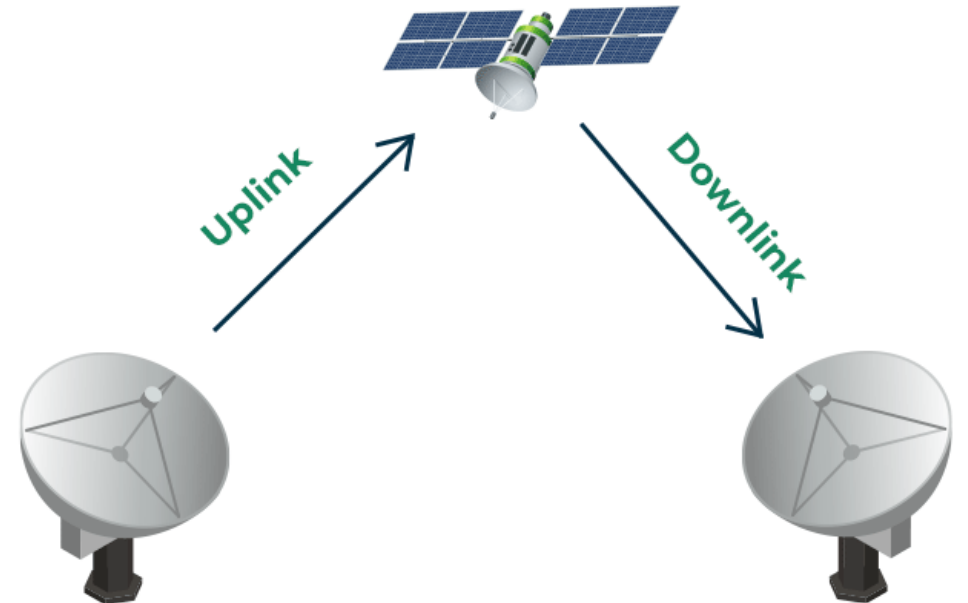
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- Future potential: IoT connectivity, space-based solar power
 - Explore emerging applications such as expanding Internet of Things connectivity through satellite networks and potential future innovations like harvesting solar power in space for Earth-based use



Components of Satellite Communications:

- The system consists of two main segments:
 - The **space segment**, which includes the satellites themselves, and
 - The **ground segment**, composed of the ground stations that manage transmission and reception.



Historical Development and Early Satellites

- The Dawn of the Space Age begin with the launch of Sputnik in 1957, the world's first artificial satellite **satellite** to orbit the Earth
 - Sputnik 1
 - Launched 4 October 1957
 - 585 mm diameter, 83 Kg weight
 - Orbital period of 96 minutes
 - Low-Earth elliptical orbit
 - 20/40 MHz transmissions could be received on the ground
 - Mainly a scientific satellite



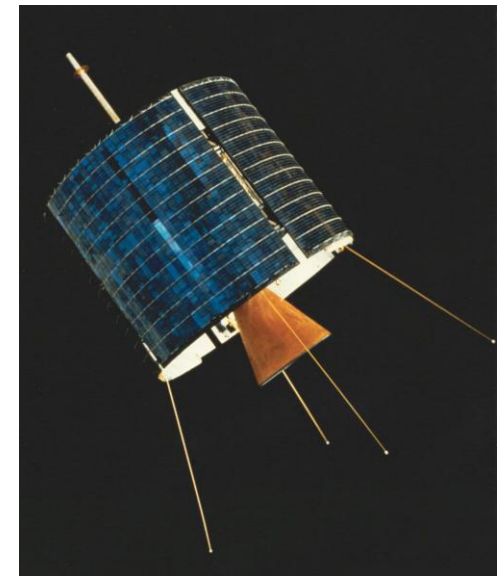
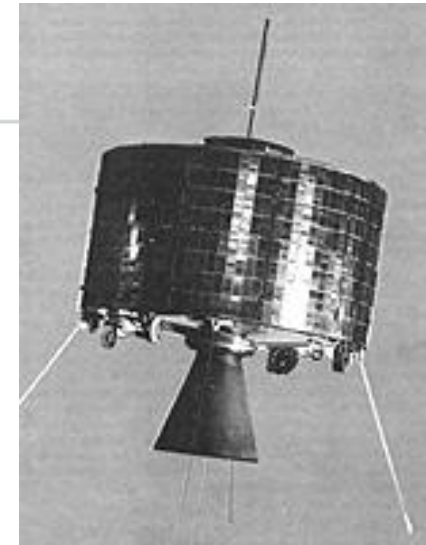
Development of Communication Satellites

- Telstar, launched in 1962, was the first active communication satellite **capable of transmitting television signals and telephone calls between the US and Europe.**
- It demonstrated the potential of satellite communication by relaying live television across the Atlantic.



Advancements in Stationary Satellites

- Major milestones
 - Syncom, launched in 1963, was the **first geostationary communication satellite**. Its **stationary position relative to the Earth's surface** made it ideal for **continuous communication operations**, setting the standard for modern communication satellites.
- Intelsat 1 (nicknamed Early Bird)
 - Launched in April 1965 in a geostationary orbit
 - The world's **first commercial communications satellite**
 - Provided the first scheduled transoceanic TV service
 - Operational for 3.5 years
 - Provided 240 voice circuits or one TV channel
 - Cylinder: 59 cm long, 72 cm diameter, 39 Kg weight



Laws governing Satellite motion (Orbital Mechanics)

- **Newton's law of motion:** The **rate of change of momentum** of a body is **equal to** (and in the same direction) **the applied force**. If m_2 denotes the mass of a satellite, v the velocity and F the applied force, then according to the law,

$$F = \frac{d(\text{momentum})}{dt} = \frac{d(m_2 v)}{dt} = m_2 \frac{dv}{dt}$$

- **Newton's law of gravitation:** The gravitational force between two bodies is directly proportional to the product of their masses and inversely proportional to the square of the distance between them.

$$F = g \frac{m_1 m_2}{r^2} \text{ where } g = 6.673 \times 10^{-11} \text{ Nm}^2 / \text{kg}^2$$

Cont'd

gm_1 is known as Keplers constant and denoted by μ .

For the simplest case, it is assumed that the orbit is circular.

$$\text{Centripetal force} = \frac{m_2 v^2}{r}$$

$$\frac{m_2 v^2}{r} = g \frac{m_1 \cdot m_2}{r^2} \Rightarrow \text{velocity} = v = \sqrt{\frac{gm_1}{r}}$$

$$\text{Period of the satellite} = T = \frac{2\pi r}{v} = 2\pi r \sqrt{\frac{r}{\mu}}$$

$$T = \frac{2\pi r^{3/2}}{\sqrt{\mu}} \quad u = Gm_1 = 3.986013 \times 10^5 \text{ km}^3/\text{s}^2 = 3.986013 \times 10^{14} \text{ Nm}^2/\text{kg}$$

Kepler's Laws of Planetary Motion

These laws provide a fundamental framework not only for celestial mechanics but also for understanding the movements of any satellites and spacecraft orbiting any celestial bodies

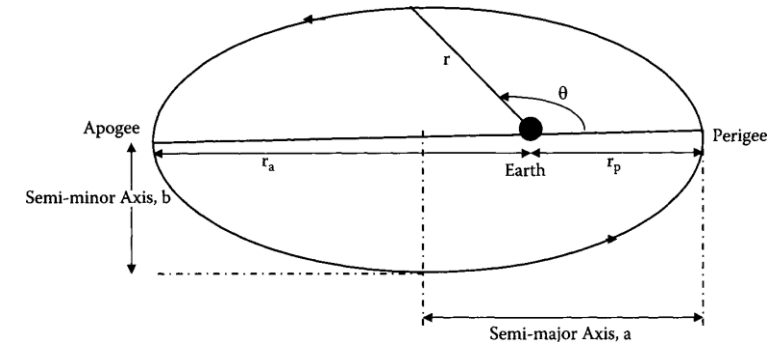
First law: The orbit of each planet follows an elliptical path in space with the sun serving as the focus.

Second law: The line linking a planet with the sun sweeps out equal areas in equal time.

Third law: The square of the period of a planet is proportional to the cube of its mean distance from the sun.

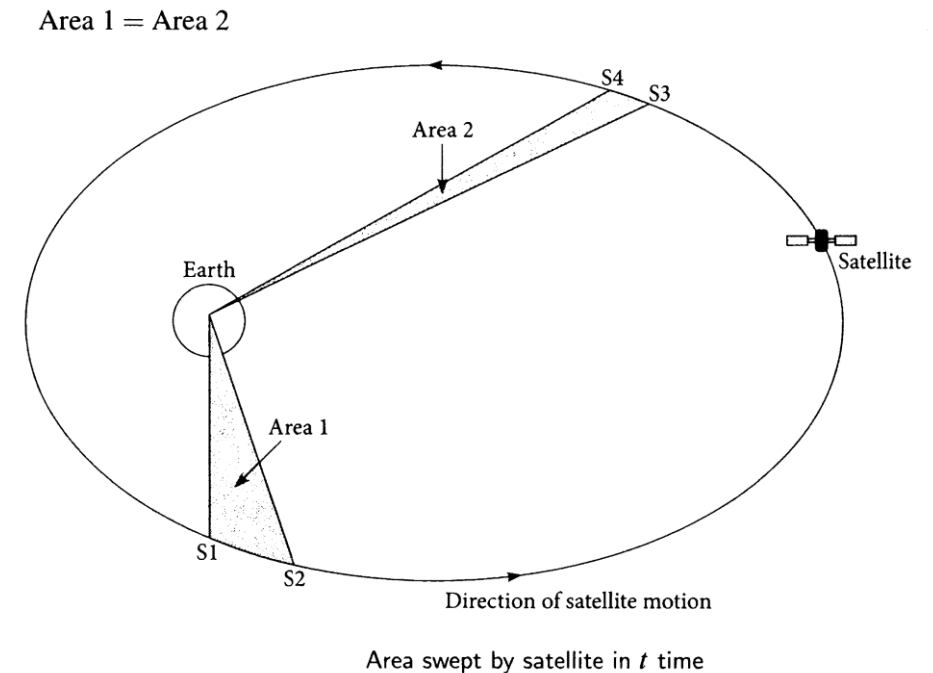
Kepler's First Law

- According to Kepler's law, All satellite move in elliptical orbits, with the earth at one focus.
- **Major axis: $2a$, Minor axis: $2b$.**
- **Eccentricity** is the measure of **deviation of an ellipse from a circle**. It is denoted by e and can be obtained by, $e = \sqrt{1 - \frac{b^2}{a^2}}$
- **Apogee:** The point on the satellite's orbit which is furthest from the earth. $R_a = a + ae$
- **Perigee:** The point on the satellite's orbit which is closest from the earth. $R_p = a - ae$
- The distance between a satellite and the geocenter is given by **polar equation of an ellipse:**
- $$r = \frac{a(1-e^2)}{1+e \cos \theta}$$



Second Law

- Kepler's second law states that a line that connects a planet to the sun sweeps out equal areas during equal intervals of time.
- *Ex: The semi-major and semi-minor axis for an elliptical satellite orbit is 160×10^6 km and 140×10^6 km respectively. Find the eccentricity, apogee and perigee distance.*



Third law

- Kepler's third law states that the ratio of the square of the orbital period of two satellites is equal to the ratio of the cube of the mean distance of each satellite from the center of the earth. Consider that two satellites S1 and S2 are at distances R_1 and R_2 respectively. If the orbital period of the satellites are T_1 , T_2 respectively, then according to Kepler's third law,

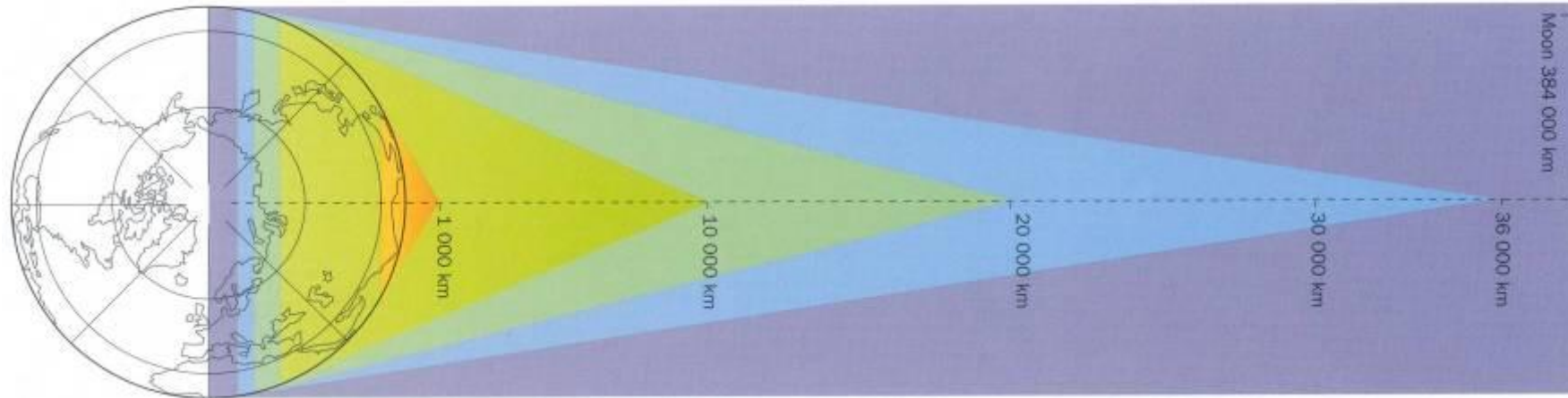
$$\frac{T_1^2}{T_2^2} = \frac{R_1^3}{R_2^3}$$

- Ex: Two satellites move in a circular orbit around the earth. The orbital period and distance from the center of the earth for the first satellite is 4 h 50 m and 220 km respectively. For the second satellite, the distance from the center of the earth is 350 km. Then calculate the orbital period.*

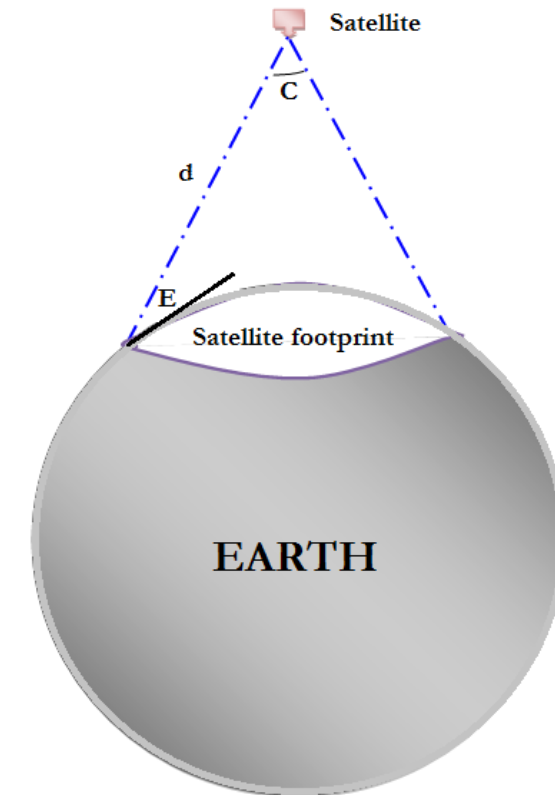
Classification of Satellite Orbits

- **Circular or elliptical orbit**
 - Circular with center at earth's center
 - Elliptical with one foci at earth's center
- **Orbit around earth in different planes**
 - Equatorial orbit above earth's equator
 - Polar orbit passes over both poles
 - Other orbits referred to as inclined orbits
- **Altitude of satellites**
 - Geostationary orbit (GEO)
 - Medium earth orbit (MEO)
 - Low earth orbit (LEO)

The view from space



- The altitude of a satellite places a fundamental limit on the fraction of the planet's surface that is visible at any given moment
- Increasing altitude $\Rightarrow$ increasing viewing area



Types of Satellite Orbits: GEO, MEO, and LEO

- GEO : Located approximately 35,786 km above the equator, remains stationary relative to the earth, ideal for communications and weather satellites
- MEO : Orbits ranging from 2,000 to 35,786 km, commonly used for navigation satellite systems like GPS
- LEO : Ranges from 160 to 2,000 km above the earth, features lower latency and is used for many modern communication applications including large constellations for broadband services



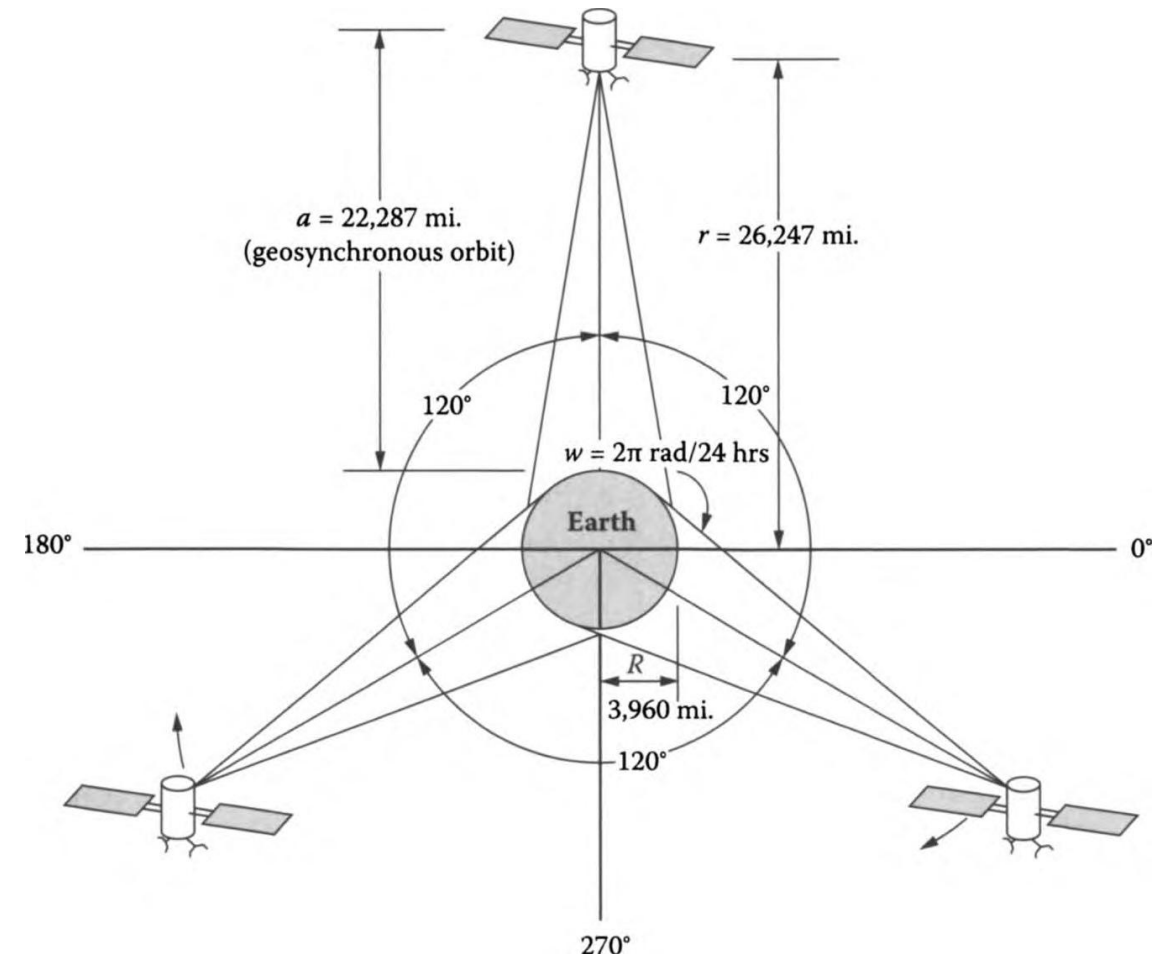
The Geosynchronous Orbit

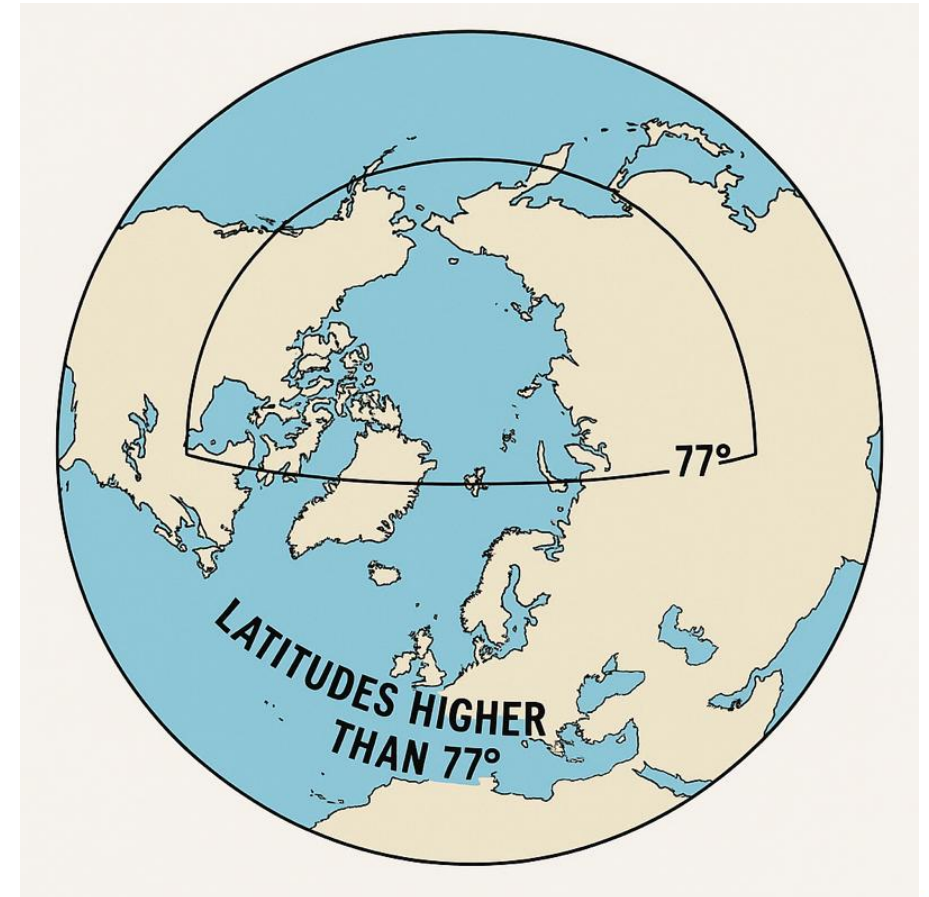
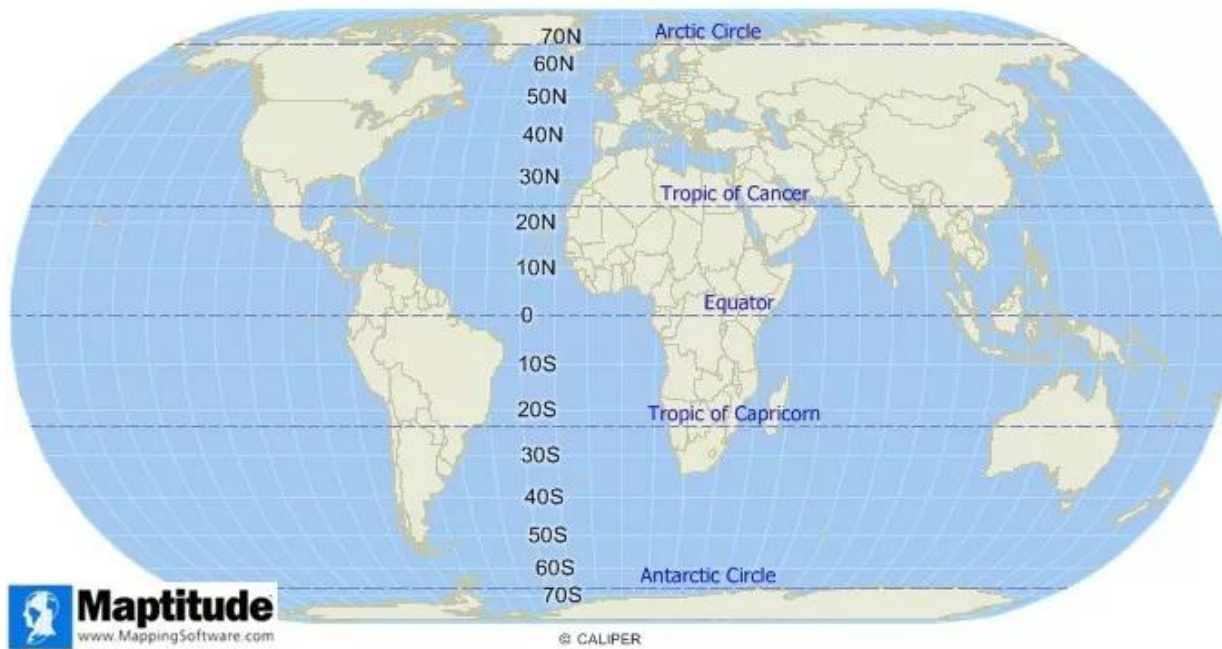
Communication satellites are usually much farther from the Earth:

- A typical distance is 36,000 km (22,300 miles) from the Earth's surface.
- A satellite needs to travel only about 3 km/s (11,000 km/h = 6,900 mph) in order to stay in orbit at that distance.
- At this speed the satellite rotates the earth in approximately 24 hours, the Earth's own rotational time.
- When the orbital period of the satellite is equal to the Earth's rotational time, the orbit is called geosynchronous

The Geostationary Earth Orbit

- In **Geostationary** Earth Orbit (GEO) the satellite remains in fixed position relative to a point of the surface of the Earth
- **Pros:** No need to track a satellite with a **steerable antenna**; only three satellites are required to cover the surface of the Earth
- **Cons:** Received signals are weak; satellites cannot be seen from latitudes higher than 77° (both north and south)

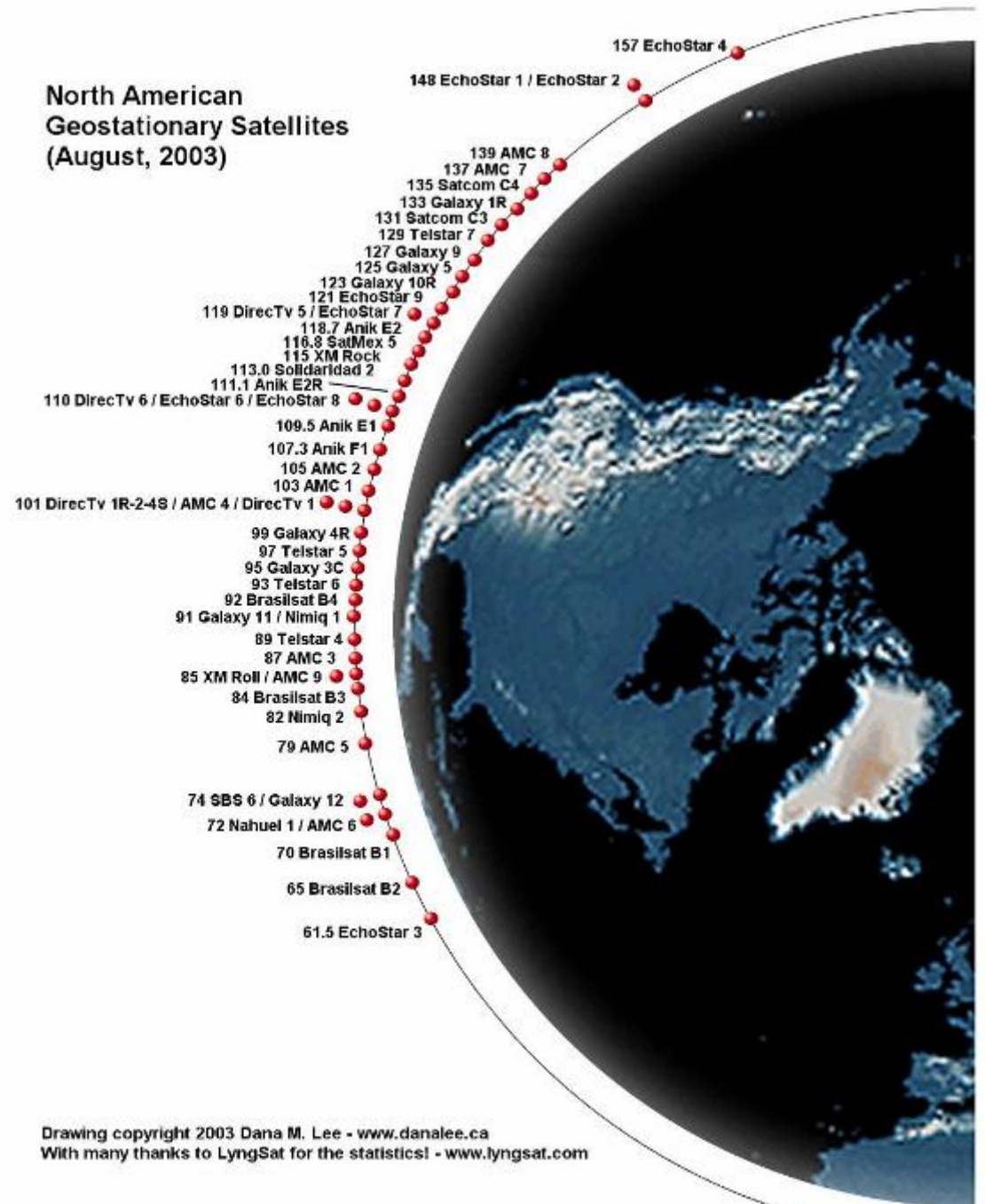




Geostationary Satellites (~600)

- Geostationary satellites occupy **prime orbits** for communication satellites - busy area of space!
- This orbit is ideal for communication and broadcast services because antennas on the **ground can remain fixed in one direction to maintain a continuous link.**
- Use attitude control (thrusters) to maintain position: “station-keeping”
- Some fuel **retained to clear station at the end of satellite’s lifetime**

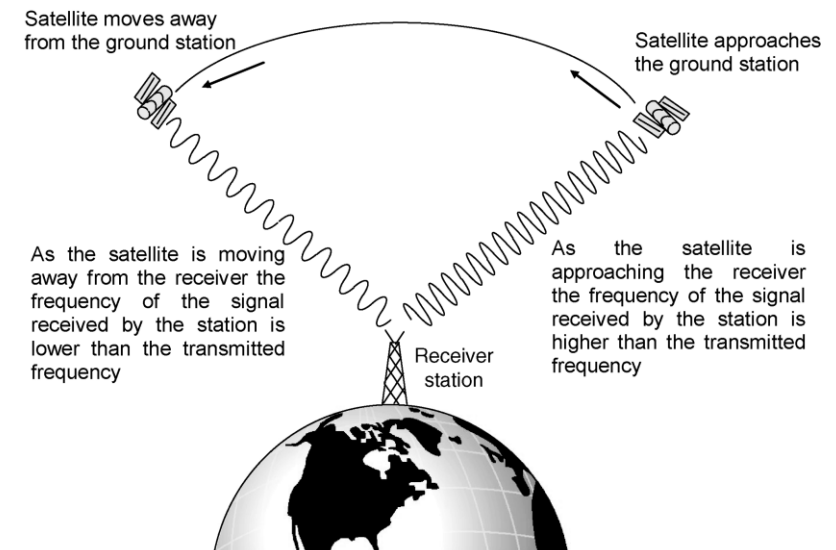
North American
Geostationary Satellites
(August, 2003)



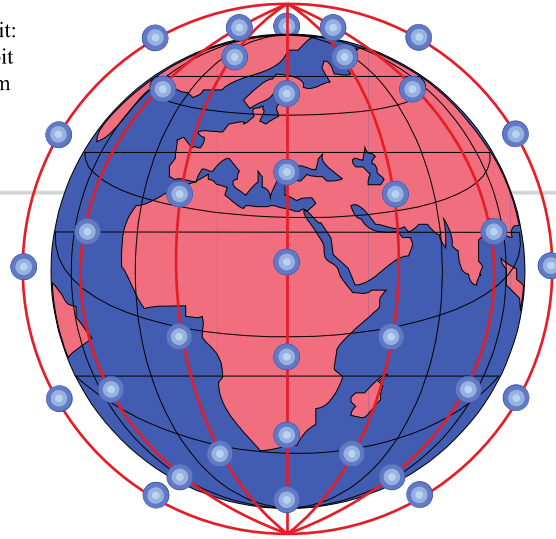
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With many thanks to LyngSat for the statistics! - www.lyngsat.com

LEO Satellite Characteristics

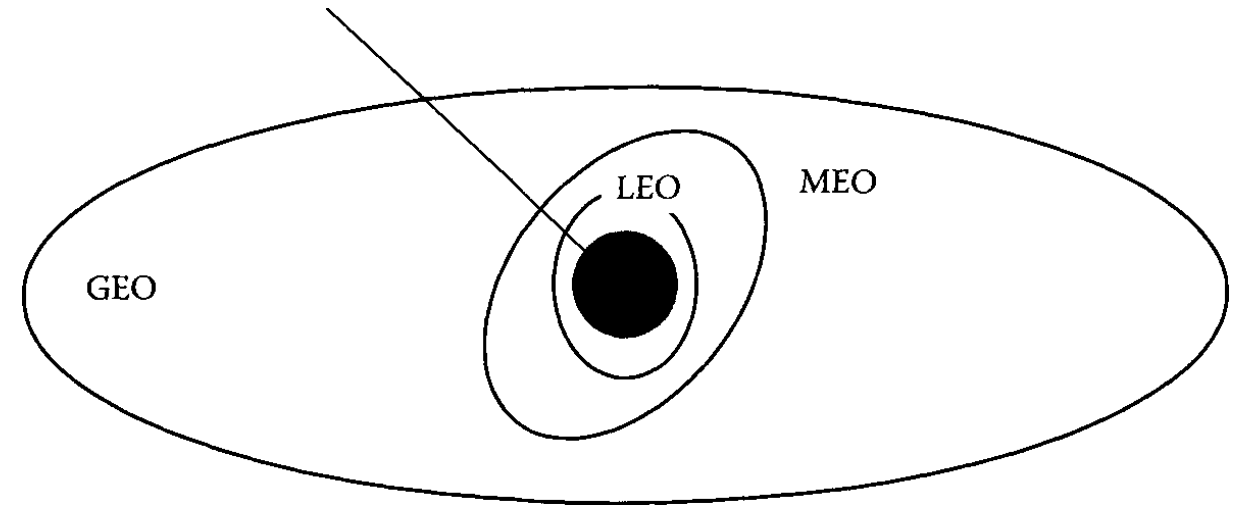
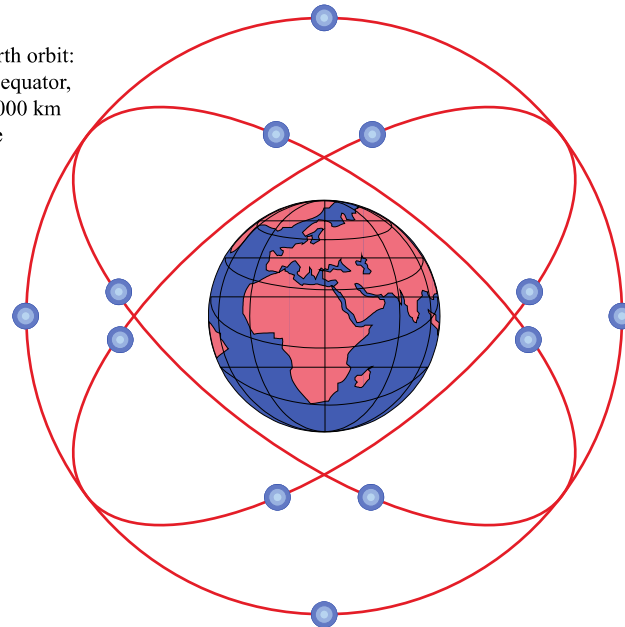
- As the name indicates, **the Low Earth Orbit** (LEO) satellites revolve the earth at a much lower altitude.
- The average distance of these satellites is 160 to 2000km from the earth's surface.
- The propagation delay (less than 20 ms) and power requirement for these satellites are lower .
- **Orbit period ranges from 1.5 to 2 hours**
- Diameter of coverage is about 8000 km
- Maximum satellite visible time up to 20 min
- To provide global coverage may require as many as 200 LEO satellites.
- System must cope with large **Doppler shifts**
- **Atmospheric drag** results in orbital deterioration



(a) Low earth orbit:
often in polar orbit
at 500 to 1500 km
altitude



(b) Medium earth orbit:
inclined to the equator,
at 5000 to 18,000 km
altitude



LEO Categories

- Little LEOs
 - Frequencies below 1 GHz
 - 5MHz of bandwidth
 - Data rates up to 10 kbps
 - Aimed at paging, tracking, and low-rate messaging
- Big LEOs
 - Frequencies above 1 GHz
 - Support data rates up to many megabits per sec
 - Offer same services as little LEOs in addition to voice and positioning services

MEO Satellite Characteristics

- The Medium Earth Orbit satellites revolve the earth in an orbit that is at a distance of about 2000 to 35000 km from the earth's surface.
- Orbit period of 6 hours
- Diameter of coverage is 10,000 to 15,000 km
- Round trip signal propagation delay less than 50 ms
- Maximum satellite visible time is a few hours
- It takes 12 MEO satellites to cover most of the planet.

Type	Altitude	Coverage	Advantages	Disadvantages
LEO	300–1,000 km	Spot	Low path loss High data rate Low delay Low launch cost Less fuel	Coverage is less Need many satellites Short orbital life High Doppler Highly complex
MEO	1,000–10,000 km	Region	Moderate path loss Moderate launch cost Less fuel	Multiple satellites Moderate coverage Highly complex
GEO	36,000 km	Earth	Global coverage Need few satellites Long orbital life Low Doppler Less complex	High path loss Long delay Low data rate High launch cost Fuel for station keeping

Limitations and Challenges of Satellite Communications

- **Signal Latency:** For GEO satellites, the high altitude results in a significant delay (approximately 250 milliseconds round-trip time), which can be problematic for latency-sensitive applications like voice over internet protocol (VoIP) or online gaming.
- **Physical and Cyber Threats:** Satellites are vulnerable to threats from [space debris](#) and other [orbital hazards](#), as well as to [interference](#) and [hacking attempts](#), which require robust security measures to ensure [data integrity and service continuity](#).

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- **Regulatory and Coordination Challenges:** The use of space for **satellite orbits and the radio frequency spectrum** needed for satellite signals are both limited resources regulated by international bodies such as the ITU.
 - **International Telecommunication Union (ITU):** The ITU plays a pivotal role in the regulation of satellite communications. It coordinates **the global use of the radio spectrum, allocates satellite orbits, and works to improve access to IT resources for underserved communities worldwide.**
 - **Frequency Allocation:** Effective management and allocation of frequency bands are crucial to avoid interference between different satellite systems.

Satellite Frequency Allocations

Frequency band	Range (GHz)
L	1–2
S	2–4
C	4–8
X	8–12
Ku	12–18
K	18–27
Ka	27–40

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- **L-band (1-2 GHz):** Widely utilized for [mobile satellite communication](#) services due to its [resilience to rain fade and atmospheric disturbances](#), making it ideal for mobile phones and data terminals that require small antennas. Its lower frequency range offers a substantial balance between coverage and the penetration capabilities required in dense urban areas.
 - **S-band (2-4 GHz):** This band is favored for [weather and maritime communication](#) as it provides a good [compromise between bandwidth and penetration through foliage or rain](#). The S-band is also used in some radar applications due to its moderate wavelength, which can detect rain droplets and other atmospheric phenomena.

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- **C-band (4-8 GHz):** Predominantly used for satellite television broadcasting and long-distance telecommunication networks because of its relatively low susceptibility to rain fade compared to higher frequency bands. It's particularly effective over tropical regions where atmospheric moisture content is high.
 - **Ku-band (12-18 GHz):** This band offers higher bandwidths and supports smaller antenna sizes compared to C-band, making it suitable for direct broadcast satellite services and fixed satellite services. It is widely adopted in commercial satellite communications for broadcasting, especially in areas with less rainfall.

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- **Ka-band (26.5-40 GHz):**
 - Known for providing **high-speed satellite Internet services due to its ability to support very high bandwidths**. The Ka-band is critical for modern high-throughput satellites (HTS), although it requires advanced technology to mitigate significant rain fade challenges.

Uplink and Downlink Configurations

- A satellite band is divided into separation portions: one for earth-to-satellite links (the uplink) and one for satellite-to-earth links (the downlink). **A satellite must use separate frequencies for sending to the satellite (the uplink) and receiving from the satellite (the downlink)**, otherwise the **powerful signal transmitted by the satellite would interfere with the weak incoming signal**.

Typical Uplink and Downlink Satellite Frequencies

Uplink frequencies (GHz)

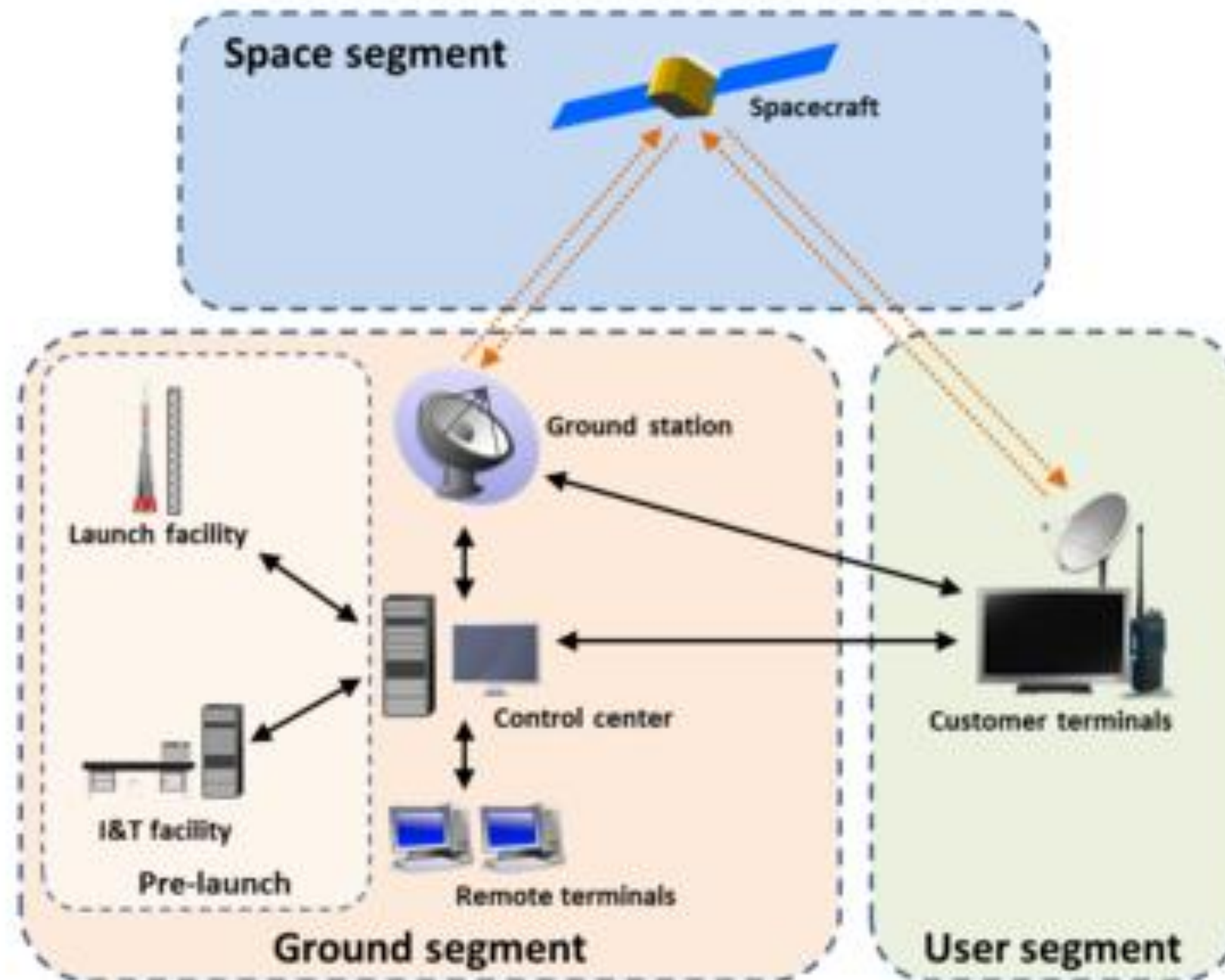
5.925–6.425
7.900–8.400
14.00–14.50
27.50–30.0

Downlink frequencies (GHz)

3.700–4.200
7.250–7.750
11.70–12.20
15.70–20.20

Key Components of Satellite Systems

- **Space Segment:** This includes the [satellite itself](#), which is equipped with payloads for various functions such as communication transponders, solar panels for power, and thrusters for maintaining orbit.
- **Ground Segment:** Consists of [all the terrestrial components necessary to support the satellite's operation](#), including transmitting and receiving stations, mission control, and other infrastructure needed to process and distribute the satellite data.
- **User Segment:** Terminals used by service customers, including ISPs and end users, are collectively called the "user segment", and are typically distinguished from the ground segment. User terminals including [satellite television systems and satellite phones](#) [communicate directly with spacecraft](#), while other types of user terminals rely on the ground segment for data receipt, transmission, and processing.

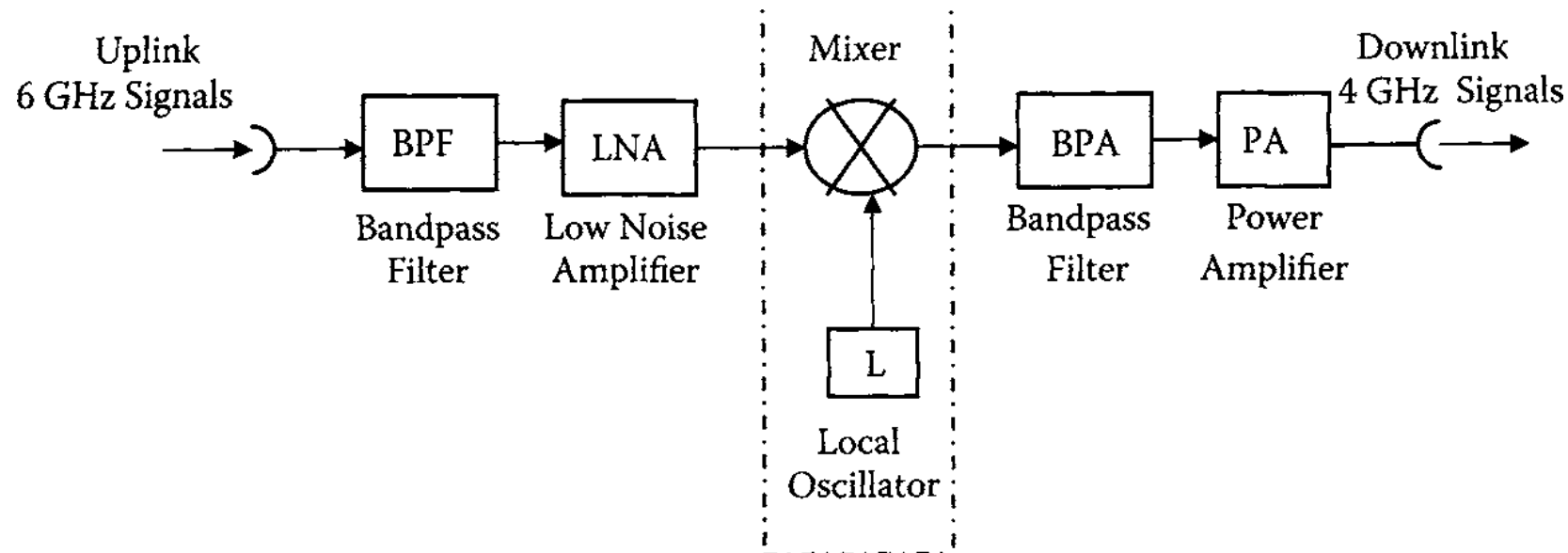


Space Segment

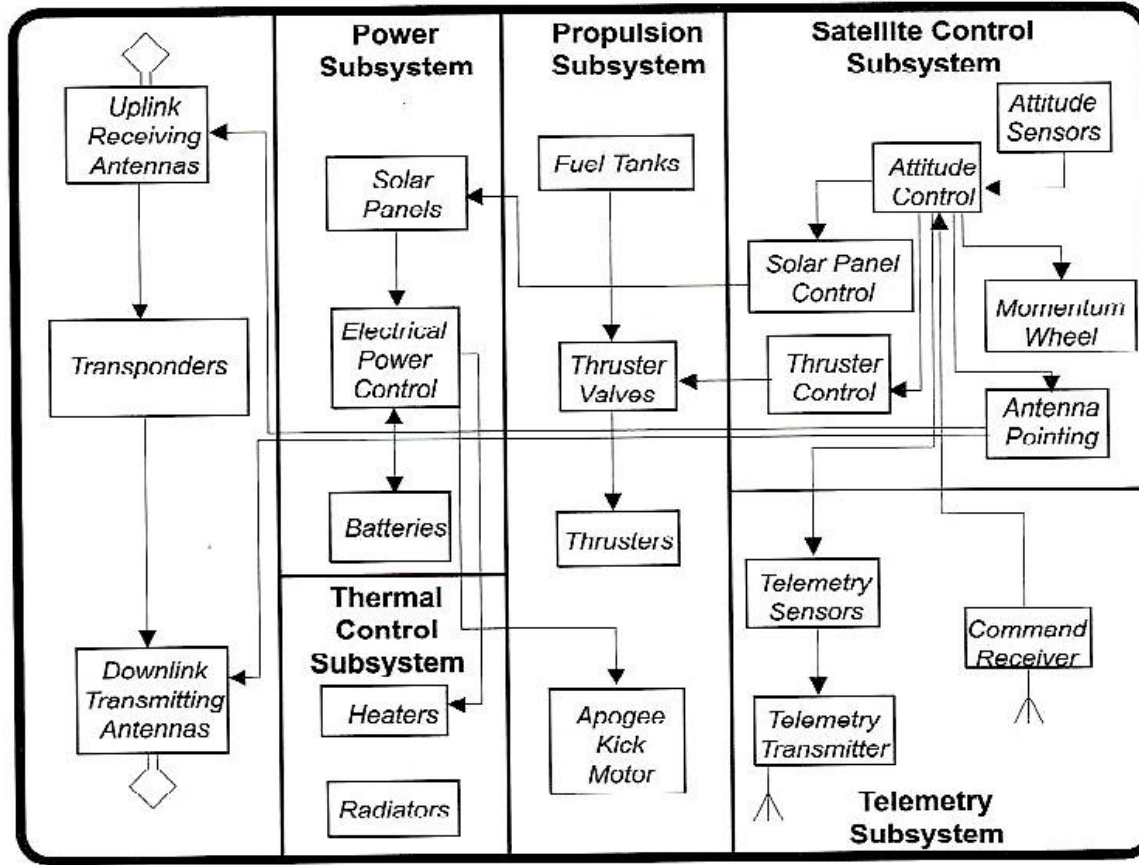
- **Transmitters:** The amount of power required by a satellite transmitter to send out depends on whether it is a GEO or LEO satellite. The GEO satellite is about 100 times farther away than the LEO satellite.
- **Antennas:** The antennas dominate the appearance of a communication satellite. The antenna design is one of the more difficult and challenging parts of a communication satellite project. **The antenna geometry is constrained physically by the design and the satellite topology.**
- **Power generation:** The satellite must generate all of its own power. The power is often generated by large solar cells, which convert sunlight into electricity. Since there is a limit to how large the solar panels can be, **there is also a practical limit to the amount of power that can be generated.**

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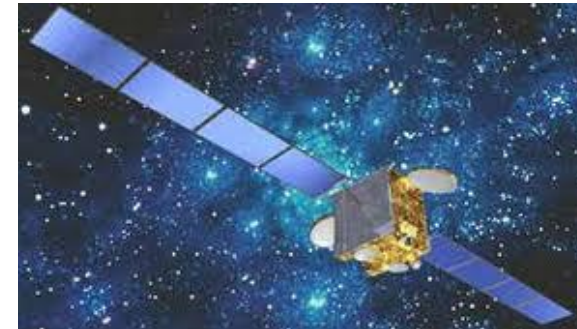
- **Telemetry and control:** This is partly implemented by the ground stations and partly by the satellite. Telemetry allows the ground station to manage the satellite.
- **Transponders:** These are the devices each satellite must carry. A transponder is equipment that receives a weak signal at one frequency, amplifies it, and changes its frequency to another for transmission to another earth station.



Space segment



Orbit Mass	1810 kg
Lifetime	12 Years
Transponder Capacity	24
Output power	90 Watts



Schematic diagram of generic major satellite systems

Satellite Transponders

- Satellite transponders are essentially repeaters in space; they receive signals from Earth, amplify them, and retransmit them back to Earth or to another satellite. This function is crucial as it compensates for the signal loss over the vast distances the signals travel in space.
- A typical transponder operates within a specific frequency range; it receives uplink signals in one band (e.g., C-band) and downlinks them in another (e.g., Ku-band) to avoid interference between the uplink and downlink signals.
- The ability of transponders to operate simultaneously in multiple frequency bands and handle different types of signals is key to the flexibility and capacity of modern communication satellites.

Ground Segment Infrastructure

- **Earth Stations:** These are the **terrestrial components** of a satellite communications system, consisting of **satellite dishes and associated control equipment that send and receive data to and from satellites.**

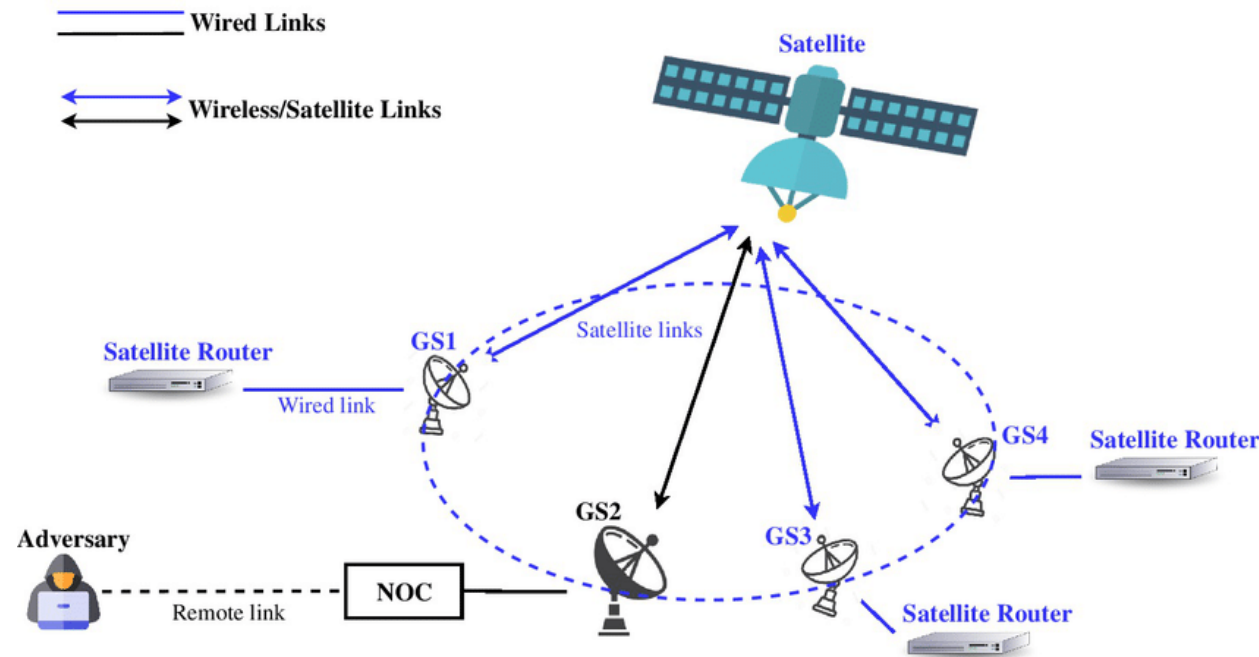


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- **Telemetry, Tracking, and Command (TTC):** These systems are vital for the operation of the satellite, managing everything **from orbital positioning to system health checks.** TTC systems ensure the satellite maintains its correct orbit and orientation, and handle command and control signals sent from ground control.

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- **Gateway Stations:** Serve as the principal nodes in a satellite communications network, **linking the satellite system with terrestrial networks**. Gateways are equipped with high-gain antennas to manage the high volumes of traffic and are strategically located to maximize coverage and connectivity.



Ground segment - Antenna design

Satellite antennas or 'dishes' comprise

- Feeder or front-end
- Reflector
- Mount (fixed / steerable)

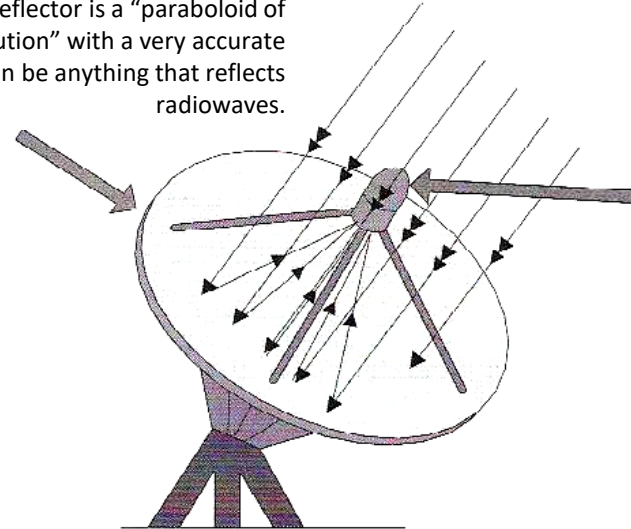
“Uplink” antenna (ground to space) requires:

- Transmitter/receiver
- Steerability (usually)

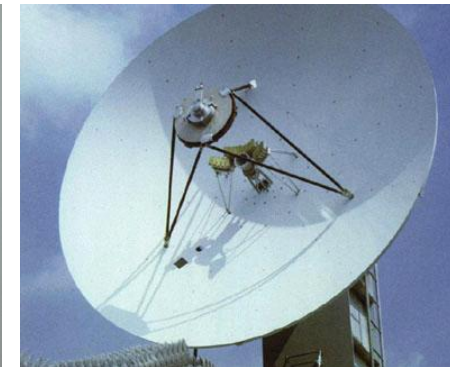
“Downlink” antenna (space to ground)

- often receiver only
- often fixed pointing

The reflector is a “paraboloid of revolution” with a very accurate surface. Can be anything that reflects radiowaves.

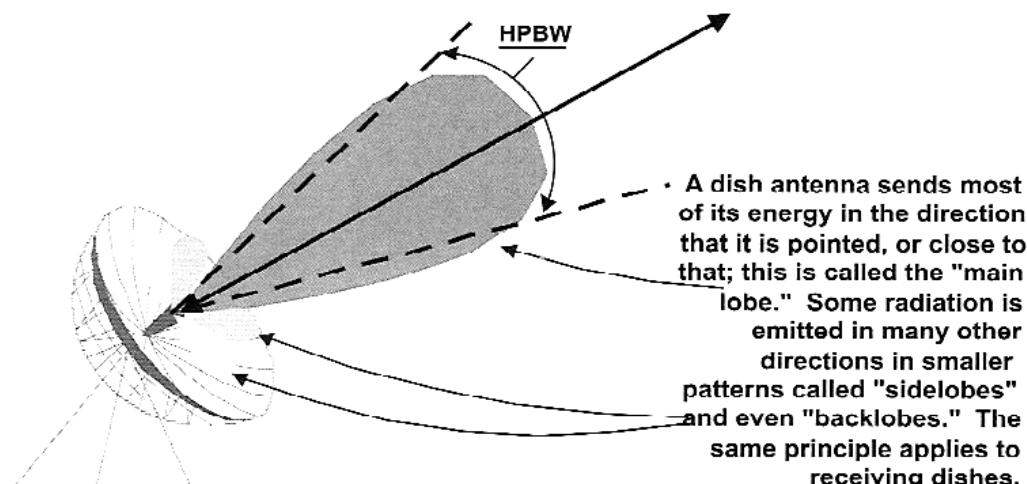
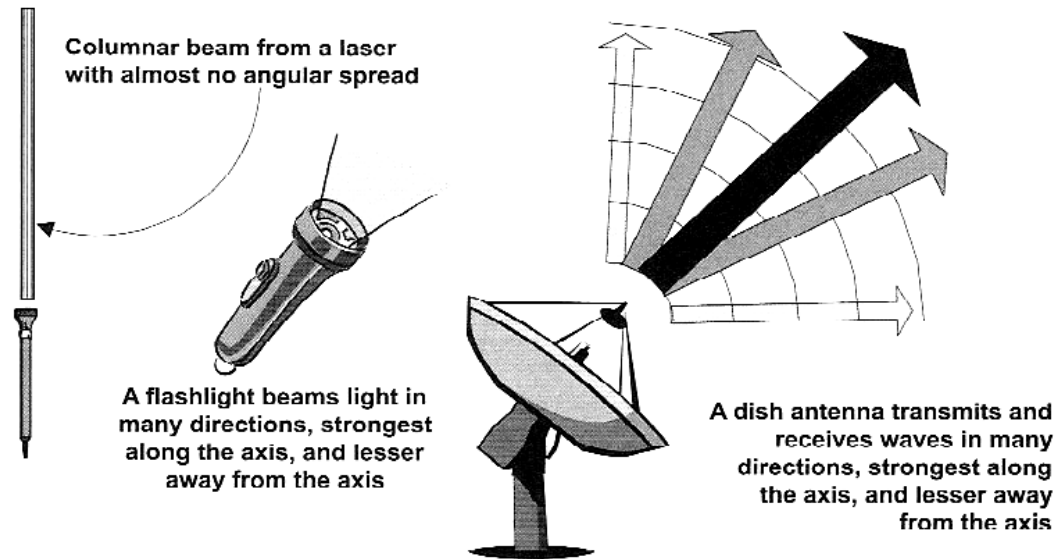


Parallel waves from a satellite are reflected to a focus (aka, feed, front-end); if there is a transmitting feed at the focus pointed at the dish, then the dish will reflect these waves and direct them toward the satellite; both transmission and reception can be done at the same time because uplink and downlink frequencies and polarizations are different



Ground segment - Antenna design

- **Transmitter:** Parabolic shape of antenna focuses electromagnetic waves outward in a parallel beam
- **Receiver:** Parabolic shape of antenna focuses incoming electromagnetic waves toward the front-end
- Focusing not perfect
 - Side lobes
 - Losses
 - Interference

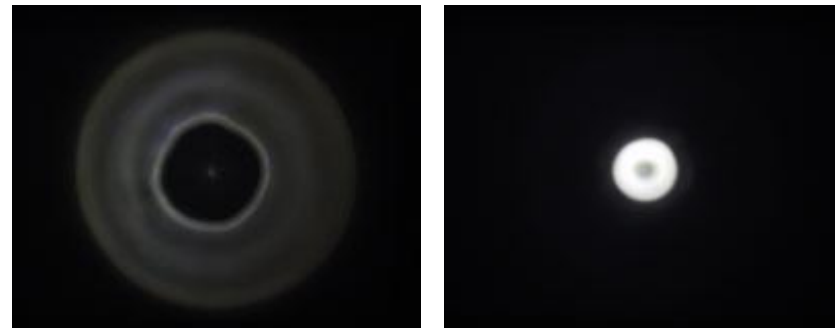
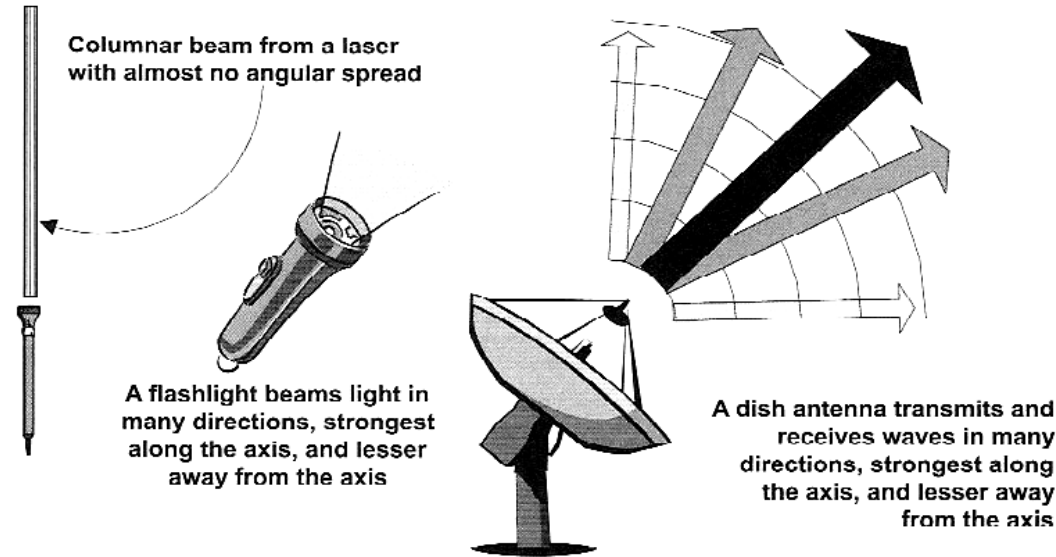


Ground segment - Antenna design

Antenna 'gain' is a measure of the ability of the dish to focus the signal for transmission / receiving

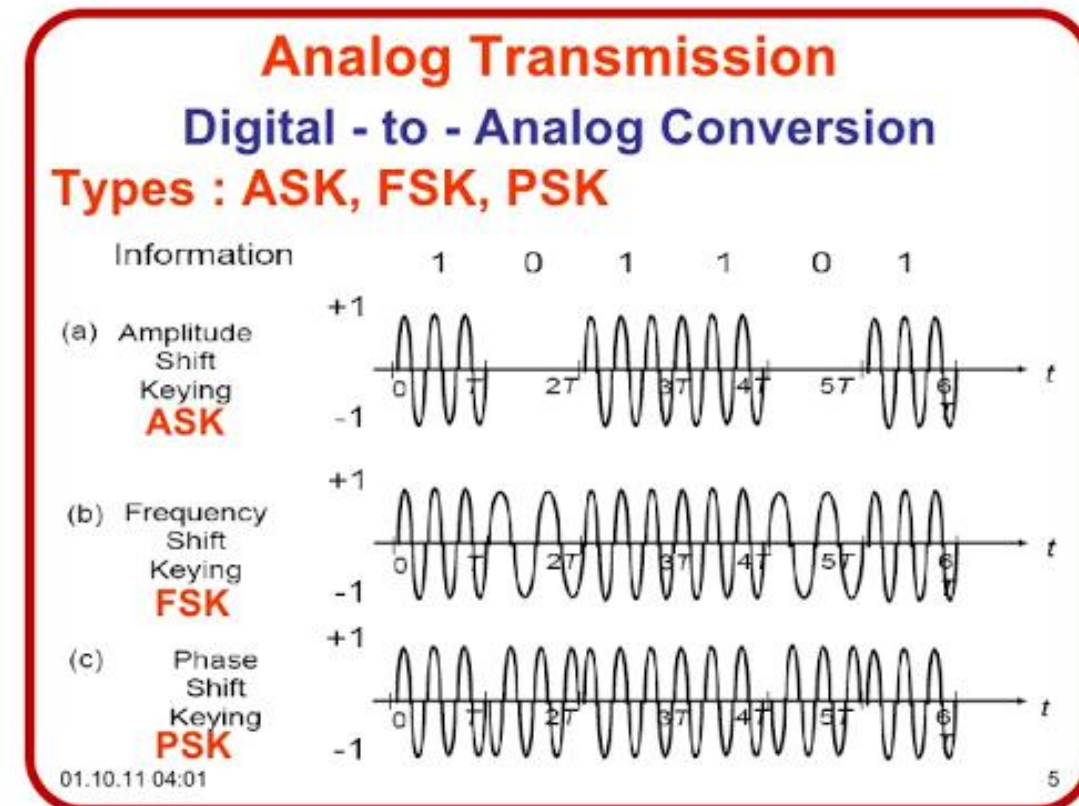
It is a geometric property of the dish (not electronic)

- small beam = high gain
- wide beam = low gain
- big dish = high gain
- small dish = low gain
- high frequency = high gain
- low frequency = low gain



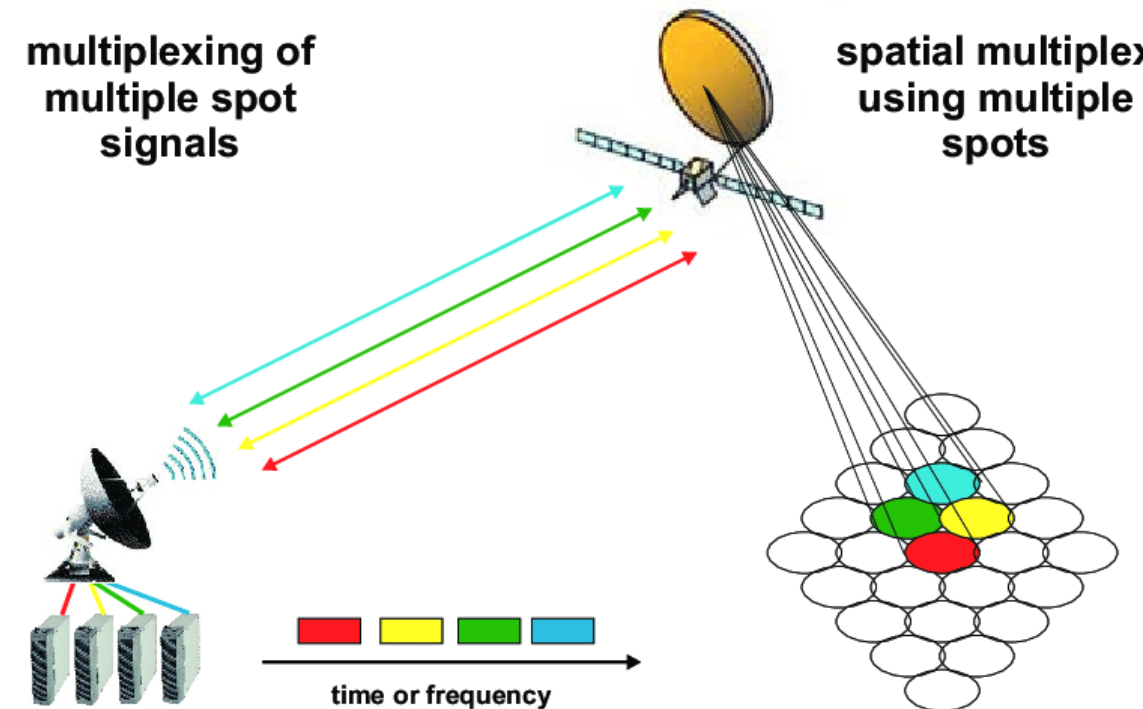
Modulation and Multiplexing Techniques

- Modulation Techniques:** In satellite communications, modulation involves varying a carrier signal in order to encode the data for transmission. Commonly used modulation schemes include **Phase Shift Keying (PSK)**, which is robust against noise and interference, making it suitable for **satellite communications**. Advanced schemes like Quadrature Amplitude Modulation (QAM) are used to increase the data rate by encoding more bits per symbol.



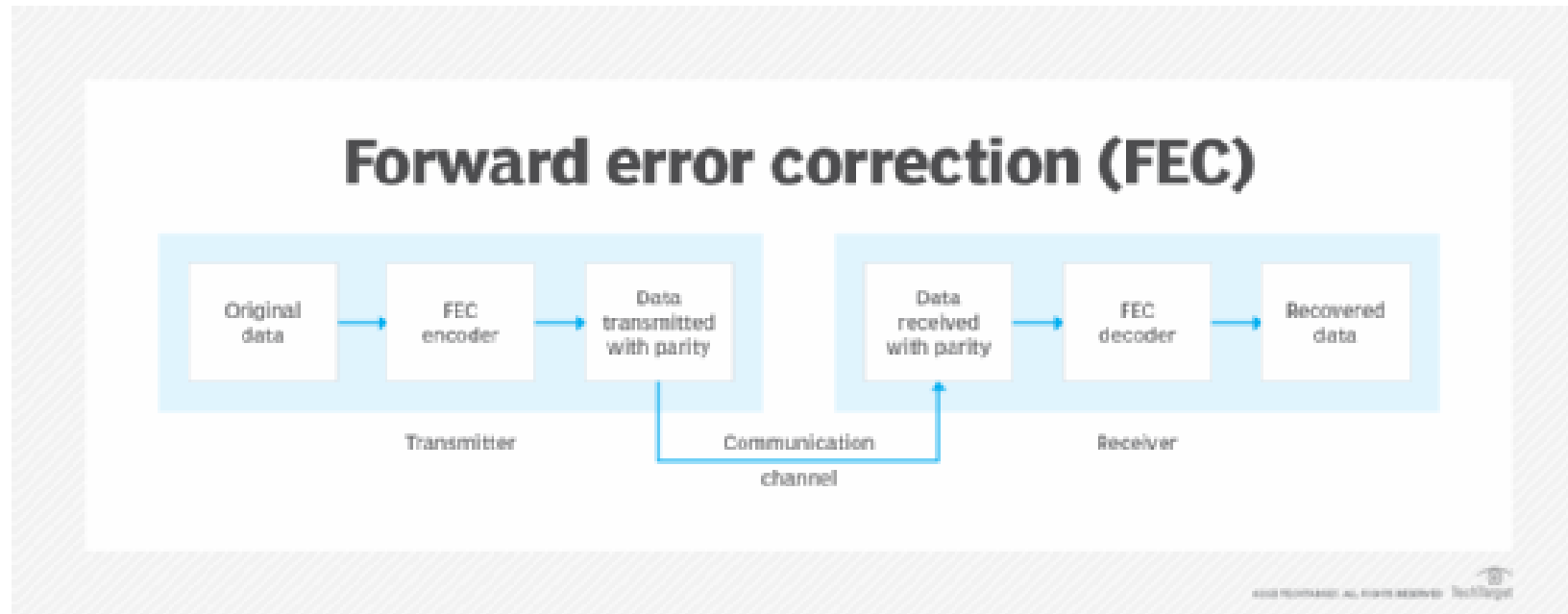
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- **Multiplexing Techniques:** Multiplexing allows multiple data streams to share the same communication channel. Time Division Multiple Access (TDMA) divides the channel into multiple time slots to serve different users, while Frequency Division Multiple Access (FDMA) assigns different frequency bands to different users. Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA) uses unique spreading codes to allow users to overlap in time and frequency, increasing spectral efficiency.



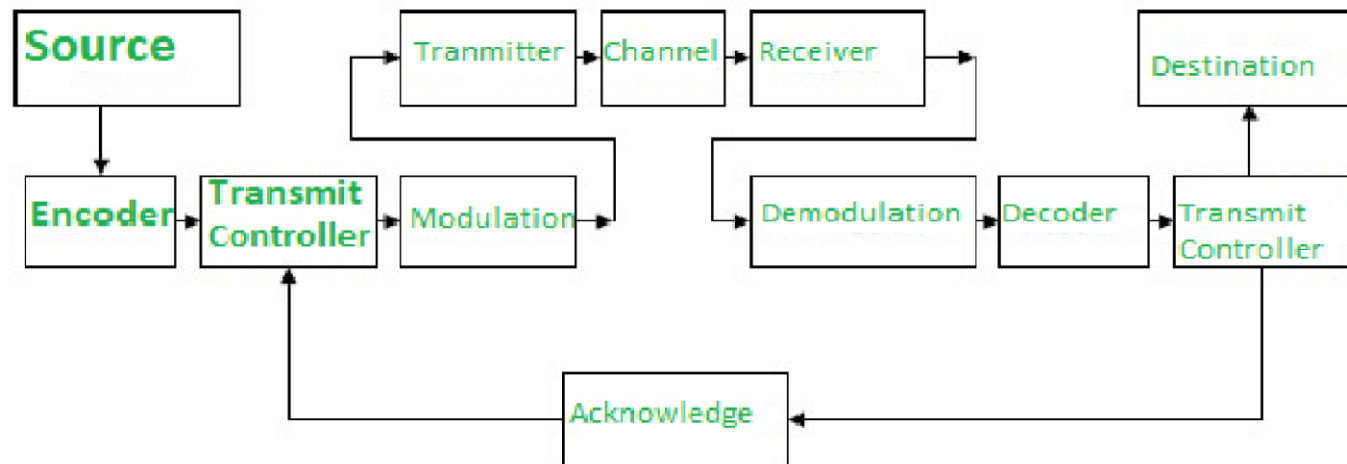
Error Control Methods

- **Forward Error Correction (FEC):** FEC involves encoding the data at the transmitter using redundant data (error-correcting codes) so that the receiver can detect and correct errors without needing a retransmission. **Popular FEC codes used in satellite communications include Convolutional Codes and Reed-Solomon Codes**, which provide robust error correction capabilities even in the noisy satellite communication environment.



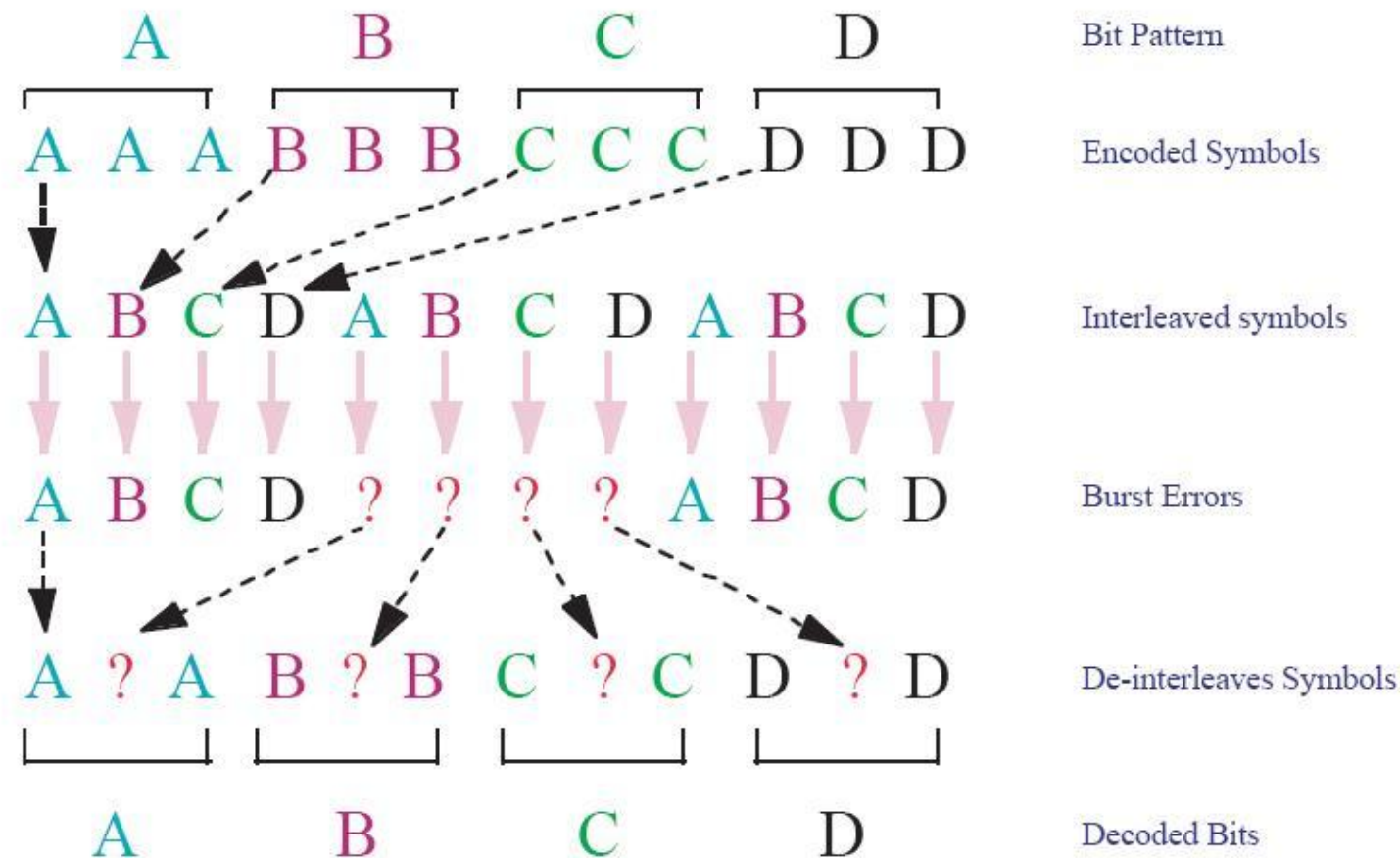
- **Automatic Repeat reQuest (ARQ):** ARQ is a mechanism for error control where the receiver detects the presence of errors and requests a retransmission of the corrupted data. ARQ is less efficient over satellite links due to the long propagation delay, but it is used in tandem with FEC to ensure data integrity in critical applications.

Automatic Repeat Request(ARQ)



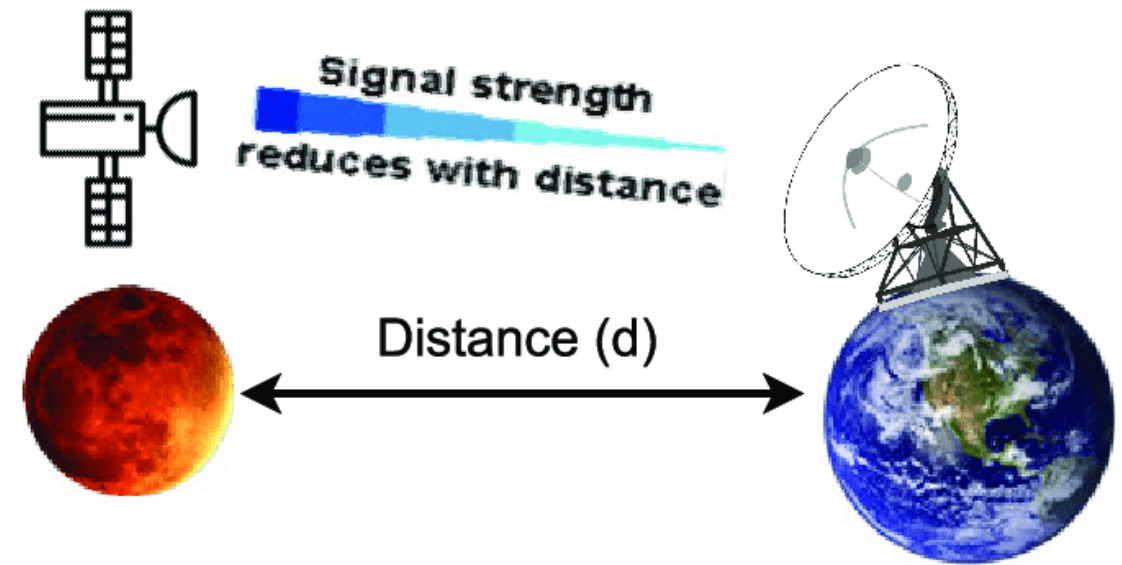
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- **Interleaving:** This technique rearranges the data bits across multiple transmitted symbols. Interleaving mitigates the effect of burst errors, which are common in satellite channels due to fading or interference, by spreading the errors over a wider range of data, thus enhancing the effectiveness of FEC.



Propagation Issues

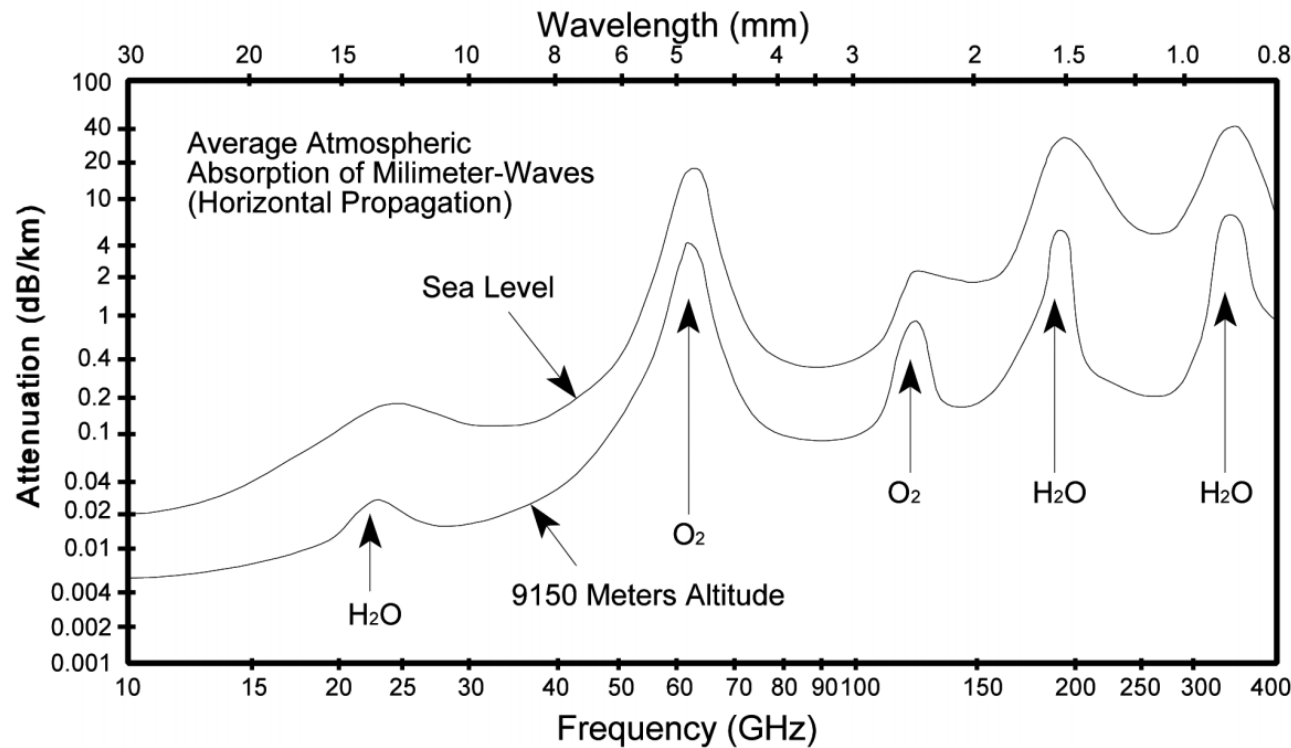
- **Path Loss:** The primary challenge in satellite communication is the significant path loss encountered as the signal travels through the vast distance of space. Path loss increases with the square of the distance from the satellite and inversely with the square of the wavelength, necessitating powerful amplifiers and sensitive receivers.



$$FSPL = \frac{P_t}{P_r} = \left(\frac{4\pi R}{\lambda} \right)^2$$

$$= \left(\frac{4\pi R f}{c} \right)^2$$

Cont'd



- **Atmospheric Absorption:** Various atmospheric gases absorb and weaken the signals as they pass through the atmosphere, particularly at higher frequency bands like Ku and Ka. Advanced forecasting and adaptive systems are used to compensate for these effects dynamically.
- **Rain Fade:** Particularly problematic at higher frequencies, rain fade refers to the absorption and scattering of signals by raindrops, leading to temporary loss of signal. Techniques such as adaptive modulation, variable coding, and power control are employed to mitigate rain fade impacts.

Encryption and Security

- **Encryption in Satellite Communications:** Given that satellite signals can be intercepted by anyone with the appropriate receiving equipment within the footprint, strong encryption is essential for securing communication. Advanced Encryption Standard (AES), a symmetric key encryption standard, is commonly used to protect sensitive data transmitted via satellite.

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- **Key Management:** Effective key management systems are crucial for ensuring the security of encrypted communications. Satellite systems often use a combination of public key infrastructure (PKI) for secure key exchange and symmetric keys for the encryption of data streams.
 - **Threats and Countermeasures:** Satellite communications face unique security challenges, including the threat of signal jamming and spoofing. Countermeasures include using spread spectrum techniques, which spread the signal across a wider bandwidth, making it harder to intercept or jam.

Future Technologies in Satellite Communications

- **Laser Communication (Optical Communication):** Laser or optical communication promises to revolutionize satellite communications by offering data transmission rates significantly higher than those possible with radio frequencies. This technology uses light to carry data, providing extremely high throughput and low latency communications between satellites and ground stations.
- **Advanced Modulation Techniques:** Future satellite systems are exploring higher-order modulation schemes like 1024-QAM or even higher, which allow more bits to be transmitted per symbol, significantly increasing the throughput without requiring additional bandwidth.

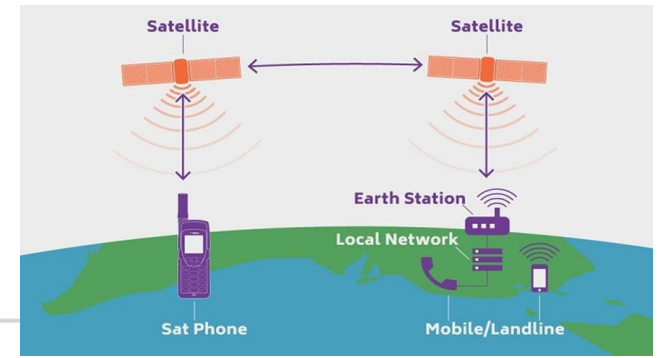
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- **On-board Processing (OBP):** Developing satellites with enhanced on-board processing capabilities is a key trend. This enables more complex processing tasks to be handled directly on the satellite, such as packet routing and data prioritization, which reduces the dependence on ground stations and decreases the communication latency.
 - **Inter-Satellite Link Technologies:** The development of robust inter-satellite links using laser communication is another promising area. These links will allow satellites within a constellation to communicate directly with each other, enhancing the network's reliability and reducing reliance on ground infrastructure.



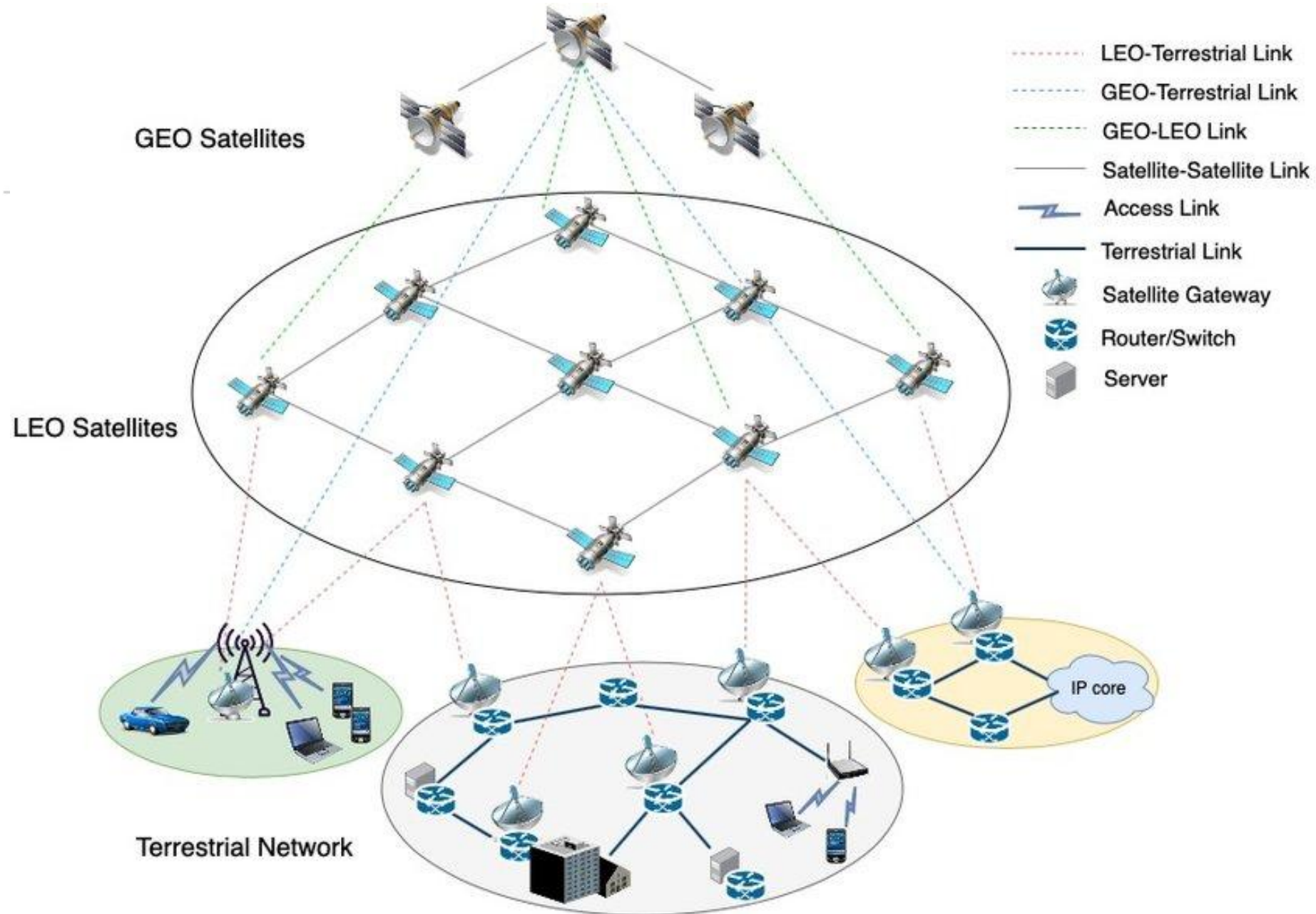
Global Impact



Satellite Mobile Communications



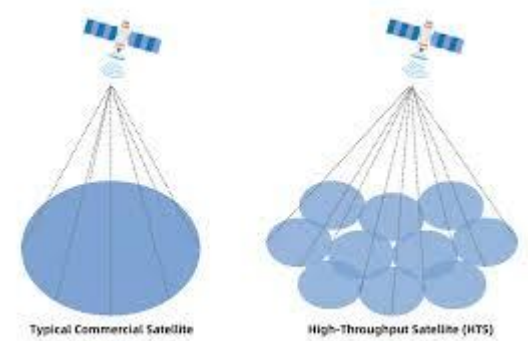
- **Mobile Satellite Services (MSS):** MSS provides vital communication links for mobile and maritime applications, [where traditional terrestrial infrastructures cannot reach](#). This service supports various applications including voice, data, and internet access on moving platforms such as ships, vehicles, and aircraft.
- **Challenges and Solutions:** The primary challenge in [MSS is maintaining a stable connection with fast-moving users, which is mitigated by using advanced tracking and beam-steering technologies](#). Additionally, the [Doppler effect](#), which can alter the frequency of signals due to relative motion between the satellite and the mobile user, must be carefully managed.



Integration of Satellite and Terrestrial Networks

- **Hybrid Network Architecture:** The integration of satellite and terrestrial networks is crucial for achieving ubiquitous global coverage and enhancing network resilience. Hybrid networks leverage the wide coverage of satellites to supplement terrestrial networks, providing a backup route for data during terrestrial network failures.
- **Technological Coordination:** Effective integration requires seamless interoperability between satellite and terrestrial technologies, which involves coordination at various levels including network architecture, protocols, and operational practices. Advanced routing and network management systems are employed to manage the traffic dynamically across both satellite and terrestrial segments.

Broadband and Multimedia Services via Satellite



- **High-Throughput Satellites (HTS):** Modern HTS are equipped with **spot-beam technology that focuses power on specific geographic areas**, allowing for frequency reuse across multiple beams. This technology significantly increases the capacity of satellites, enabling them to support broadband and multimedia services.
- **Service Provision:** Satellite broadband **can deliver internet speeds comparable to terrestrial broadband, supporting high-bandwidth applications such as HD video streaming**, fast broadband internet, and large-scale enterprise applications.

Disaster Recovery and Emergency Communications

- **Role in Crisis Management:** Satellites are inherently resilient to ground-based disruptions such as natural disasters, making them ideal for emergency communications. They provide a critical link when terrestrial networks are unavailable, supporting coordination and communication among disaster response agencies.
- **Rapid Deployment Capabilities:** Portable satellite equipment can be quickly deployed to disaster zones, establishing temporary communication links. These systems are essential for coordinating rescue efforts, medical care, and relief distribution.



Military Applications of Satellite Communications

- **Secure and Reliable Communications:** Military satellites provide **secure, encrypted communications channels that are vital for modern warfare**, supporting everything from tactical field communications to strategic command over vast distances.
- **Surveillance Capabilities:** Satellites equipped with **high-resolution cameras and sensors play a crucial role in global surveillance, providing critical data on military movements and activities**. This capability is essential for maintaining situational awareness and preparing for potential threats.
- **Precision Navigation:** The use of satellite-based navigation systems is indispensable in military operations, offering accuracy for positioning, navigation, and timing (PNT) that is critical for everything from troop maneuvering to guiding precision munitions.

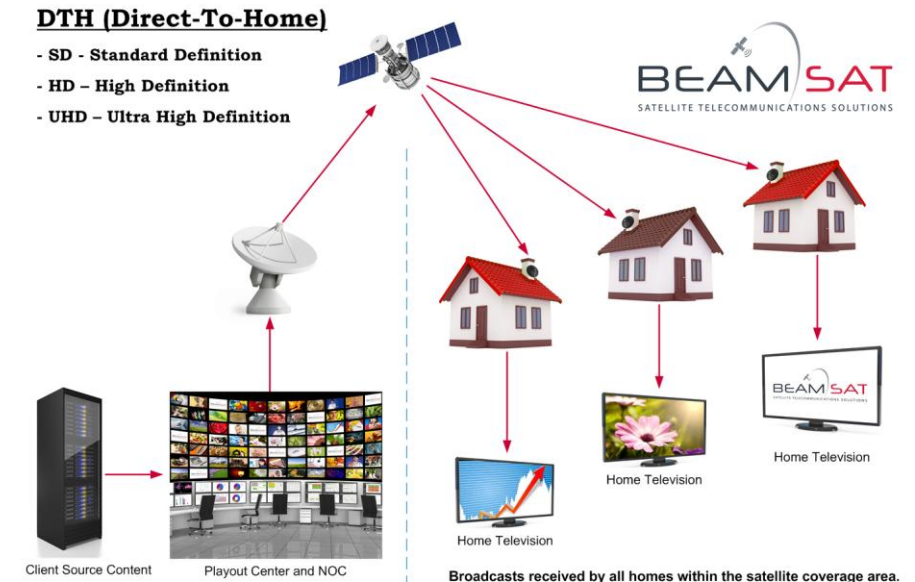
Satellite Communications in Maritime and Aeronautical Contexts



- **Maritime Communication Needs:** Satellite communications are integral to maritime safety and operations, enabling ships to stay connected for both routine operations and emergency communications. This connectivity is essential for navigating through remote oceanic regions where no other communication infrastructure exists.
- **Aeronautical Connectivity:** In the aviation sector, satellites facilitate essential communications between aircraft and ground controllers, especially over unmonitored airspaces. Additionally, they provide passengers with in-flight broadband services that have become an expectation on commercial flights.

Direct-to-Home Television and Radio Broadcasting via Satellite

- **Broadcasting Mechanism:** DTH technology transmits broadcast signals directly to satellite dishes installed at subscribers' premises. This technology bypasses the need for traditional ground-based cable infrastructures, using geostationary satellites to cover wide areas with a multitude of television and radio channels.
- **Market Transformation:** Satellite DTH services have dramatically transformed the broadcasting landscape by offering an extensive array of programming with better audio and video quality. They also provide services such as video on demand and interactive television, enhancing viewer engagement.



Rural and Remote Area Connectivity Solutions

- **Critical Role in Digital Inclusion:** Satellite technology is key to overcoming geographical barriers in rural and remote areas, providing essential communication services that facilitate access to information, e-governance, education, and health services.
- **Implementation of Satellite Solutions:** To serve these areas, operators deploy geostationary satellites that can offer wide coverage with consistent service quality. Emerging technologies like LEO satellite constellations are also becoming popular for their ability to provide higher bandwidth and lower latency, further enhancing user experience.

Environmental Monitoring and Meteorological Satellites

- **Environmental Monitoring:** Satellites equipped with Earth observation instruments play a pivotal role in monitoring environmental changes, such as deforestation, urbanization, and the effects of climate change. Instruments like multispectral imagers and radar altimeters provide critical data that support global efforts in environmental protection and sustainability.
- **Meteorological Applications:** Meteorological satellites are essential for weather forecasting and monitoring natural phenomena like hurricanes, storms, and volcanic activities. They provide valuable data that helps in preparing for weather-related disasters, significantly reducing potential damage and enhancing public safety.



Telemedicine and Educational Outreach via Satellite

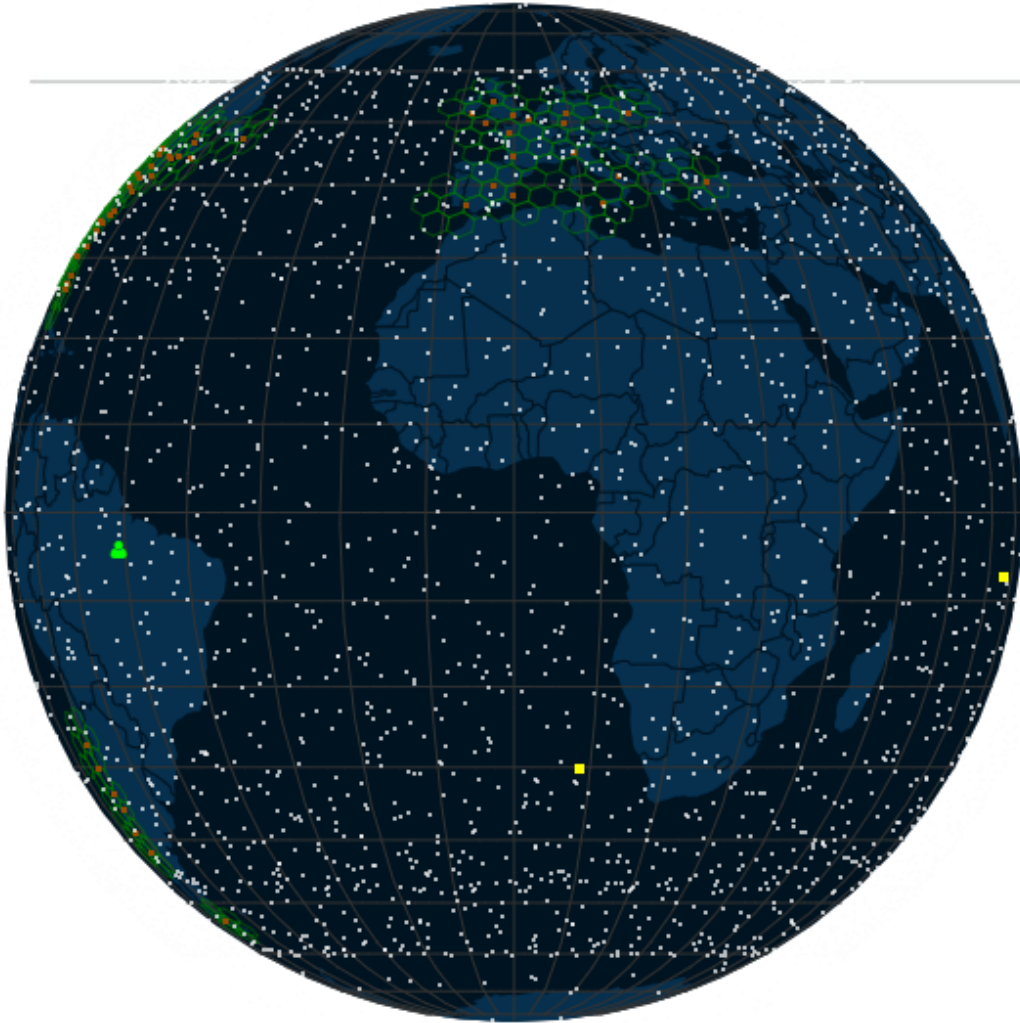
- **Telemedicine Services:** Satellite communications enable telemedicine services by connecting remote health centers with specialists worldwide. This is crucial for rural areas where access to healthcare is limited. Through real-time video conferencing, remote diagnostics, and health data transmission, satellite technology is improving patient outcomes in underserved regions.
- **Educational Programs:** Satellite communications also facilitate educational outreach in isolated communities. Educational content can be broadcasted live or stored for on-demand access, providing students in remote locations with educational resources comparable to those available in urban centers.

Satellite Internet: Providers and Technologies

- **Satellite Internet Overview:** Satellite internet services allow users in remote or underserved areas to access high-speed internet via communications satellites. Unlike traditional broadband, satellite internet can reach virtually any location with a clear view of the sky, making it a crucial service for rural communities.
- **Key Providers:** Companies like [HughesNet](#) and [Viasat](#) are prominent providers in the satellite internet market. They utilize geostationary satellites to offer coverage across wide areas, with systems designed to support internet browsing, streaming, and communications.
- **Technological Innovations:** Recent developments include the deployment of LEO satellite constellations by companies such as [SpaceX \(Starlink\)](#) and [OneWeb](#), which aim to reduce latency and increase internet speeds, making satellite internet

Starlink Satellite Broadband

- **Overview of Starlink:** Developed by SpaceX, Starlink aims to build [a satellite internet constellation to deliver high-speed, low-latency internet worldwide](#). This service is particularly targeted at rural and remote areas where traditional broadband is unavailable or inefficient.
- **Mission and Scope:** With [over 5,874 satellites already in orbit](#), Starlink's goal is to eventually expand to nearly 42,000 satellites, providing global coverage and reliable internet services across every corner of the planet.
- **Current Deployment Status:** [Continuously launching satellites](#) in batches using SpaceX's Falcon 9 rockets, significantly increasing the constellation's size and the network's capacity.



Technological Foundations of Starlink

- **Low Earth Orbit Configuration:** Starlink satellites operate between 540 and 570 kilometers above Earth—much lower than traditional geostationary satellites at 35,786 kilometers. This proximity reduces the signal latency and increases communication speed.
- **Benefits of LEO Satellites:** The use of LEO satellites helps achieve **lower latency and faster data speeds**, which are crucial for applications requiring real-time connectivity, such as video calls and online gaming.

Recent Technological Advancements in Starlink

- **Optical Inter-satellite Links:** Recent batches of Starlink satellites are equipped with laser links that allow them to transfer data between each other in space without the need to pass data through ground stations, reducing latency and dependency on terrestrial infrastructure.
- **Efficient Satellite Deployment:** Leveraging the reusability of Falcon 9 rockets, SpaceX has optimized the cost and frequency of launches, allowing for rapid expansion of the Starlink network.

Starlink's Ground Station Network

- **Importance of Ground Stations:** While satellites handle space-based transmission, ground stations play a critical role in linking the satellite network to the traditional internet, managing the data flow between users and the wider internet.
- **Expansion Strategy:** To minimize latency and enhance service quality, [Starlink is strategically increasing the number of ground stations worldwide](#), ensuring robust coverage and network reliability.

Performance and Capabilities

- **Service Performance:** Users have reported download speeds exceeding 200 Mbps and latency figures around 20-40 milliseconds, marking significant improvements over typical satellite internet services and rivalling or surpassing terrestrial broadband solutions.
- **Network Scalability:** Ongoing upgrades to satellite technology aim to further increase the network's throughput and reduce interference with other satellite operations, enhancing the overall user experience.

Impact on Global Internet Accessibility

- **Bridging the Digital Divide:** Starlink's ability to provide high-speed internet access in geographically challenging or economically non-viable areas can significantly impact education, healthcare, and economic development by connecting these regions to global resources.
- **Global Reach:** The project aims to extend [reliable internet access to every corner of the globe](#), supporting global communication and information exchange, essential for modern societies.

Challenges and Criticisms

- **Space Debris and Traffic Management:** The deployment of thousands of satellites raises concerns about space debris and the potential for collisions, necessitating advanced traffic management and debris mitigation strategies.
- **Astronomical Interference:** The visibility of Starlink satellites has raised concerns in the astronomical community about their impact on night sky observations and scientific research, leading to discussions about mitigation measures like satellite dimming.

Future Developments and Goals

- **Next-Generation Satellites:** SpaceX plans to introduce **more advanced satellites with improved bandwidth**, better energy efficiency, and enhanced security features to protect data transmission.
- **Expansion Objectives:** Starlink continues to **pursue broader coverage and integration** with terrestrial networks and emerging technologies such as 5G and the Internet of Things (IoT), aiming to create a seamless global communication network.

Future Prospects and Ongoing Research in Satellite Communications

- **Innovative Research Areas:** Ongoing research in satellite communications focuses on improving communication efficiency and reducing costs. Areas of intense research include quantum communications for enhanced security, development of ultra-high-frequency bands for greater data throughput, and machine learning algorithms for optimizing network management and satellite operations.
- **Emerging Technologies:** The integration of satellite communications with 5G and forthcoming 6G networks promises to expand the capabilities of mobile networks, particularly in terms of seamless global coverage and support for new services like the Internet of Things (IoT) and autonomous vehicles.



Thank you